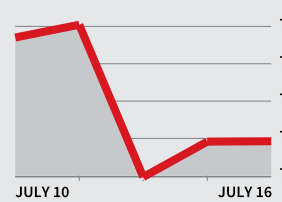


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77186.87 (+1.44)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24072.75	-5.75
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.93	0
US Dollar (in ₹)	96.34	+0.09
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	141112.00	-228
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	217434.00	-2277

CASTING NETS WIDE.

The Union government is preparing an export-oriented policy for fisheries with a special emphasis on inland fishery **p10**



VISA CLAMPDOWN.

Trump administration plans to reduce the visa duration for foreign students, journalists **p9**

QUICKLY.

MAHI BANSWARA PLANT
₹28,000 crore EPC tender floated for nuclear project



New Delhi: The government has floated an EPC tender worth more than ₹28,000 crore for the recently inaugurated nuclear power plant at Mahi Banswara in Rajasthan. Anushakti Vidhyut Nigam, a joint venture of NPCIL and NTPC, released the tender, inviting bids for the package. This is the largest nuclear island EPC package floated for India's pressurised heavy water reactor programme. **p3**

STRONG DEMAND

SBI Funds IPO subscribed 41.66 times on final day

Bengaluru: The SBI Funds Management IPO was subscribed 41.66 times on the final day of bidding, led by strong demand from QIBs. As against the IPO size of ₹9,813 crore, the offer received bids for ₹2.98 lakh crore. The QIB portion was subscribed 140.11 times, while non-institutional investors category saw subscription of 22.51 times. **p6**

Govt floats CAFE-III with super credits, carbon trading

ROAD AHEAD. Draft norms retain fleet-average approach, tighten emission targets

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

A day after issuing draft amendments to the existing CAFE-II regulations, the Ministry of Power (MoP) on Thursday released the draft Corporate Average Fuel Economy (CAFE-III) norms for 2027 and invited comments from stakeholders. The new norms, which will replace CAFE-II after March 31, 2027, seek to progressively tighten fuel efficiency standards while retaining the fleet-average compliance approach.

The move comes after the implementation of CAFE-II, which had drawn mixed responses from automakers. While the industry broadly accepted stricter fuel-efficiency targets, it had expressed concerns over compliance costs and the pace of transition to cleaner technologies.

FLEET EMISSIONS

The proposed CAFE-III framework retains the government's emphasis on re-

TIMELINE OF EVENTS

- September 2025: Ministry of Power (MoP) proposes relief for sub-4-metre petrol cars, incentives for electric vehicles with range extenders
- April 2026: Removes vehicle size/category-wise incentives from draft
- April 2026: Blame game over CAFE-II dues stalls rollout of CAFE-III
- April 2026: Industry, government agree on final draft
- July 15, 2026: MoP invites automakers for suggestions/objections on amendments to CAFE-II
- July 16, 2026: MoP circulates draft CAFE-III for stakeholder consultation



ducing overall fleet emissions, rather than regulating vehicles based on size. To reach net-zero goals, the framework introduces a market-based credit trading system, besides incentivising the shift to electric, hybrid and flex-fuel vehicles.

It also introduces a market-based credit trading mechanism that will allow manufacturers exceeding targets to earn tradable credits. The proposal, however, is likely to revive the debate

over carbon credits, with critics arguing that such mechanisms could allow some manufacturers to continue emitting more by purchasing credits, instead of making technological improvements.

Tata Motors has opposed the Bureau of Energy Efficiency's (BEE) compliance credit mechanism, arguing that allowing BEE to directly sell carbon credits will compromise its neutral status and disrupt fair price discov-

ery. According to the newly-released CAFE-III norms, manufacturers will continue to be regulated on the basis of annual fleet-average fuel consumption with progressively tighter standards.

MSIL to challenge Raipur consumer forum order

Maruti Suzuki India Ltd (MSIL) said it will challenge an order of the District Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission, Raipur, which directed the company to replace a customer's vehicle with a new E20 vehicle. The statement comes after the Commission asked the Maruti Suzuki dealer in Raipur to replace the vehicle — Grand Vitara Intelligent Electric (Strong Hybrid) Zeta Plus 1.5 CVT — bought by a doctor, which was E20-compliant, after holding that the dealer sold a vehicle made 16 months ago and failed to rectify recurring engine problems despite repeated repairs.

See p2

Tech Mahindra outshines Wipro in Q1 with strong profit and revenue growth

Sanjana B
Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai/Bengaluru

Performance contrast

Wipro	FY27 Q1	FY26 Q1	Tech Mahindra	FY26 Q1	FY27 Q1
Revenue (₹ cr)	24,479	22,134	Revenue (₹ cr)	13,351	15,711
Profit (₹ cr)	3,352	3,330	Profit (₹ cr)	1,128	1,486
Employee count	2,43,044	2,33,232	IT Headcount	79,987	74,689

Tech Mahindra outperformed Wipro in the June quarter of FY27, posting broad-based growth in revenue, profit and margins, while Wipro continued to grapple with pressure on profitability despite delivering revenue growth. The two IT services companies announced their June quarter earnings on Thursday.

Tech Mahindra posted a 17.6 per cent year-on-year rise in revenue at ₹15,711 crore. Net profit stood at ₹1,486 crore, up 31.6 per cent y-o-y. On a sequential basis, revenue grew 4.2 per cent and profit rose 9.5 per cent, supported by improvements across its IT and business process services businesses. The company's operating performance also strengthened, with EBITDA climbing 53.5 per cent y-o-y and 8.6 per cent sequentially to ₹2,264 crore. EBITDA margin expanded 60 bps quarter-on-quarter to 14.4 per cent.

CLIENT BASE EXPANDS

Deal momentum remained healthy as Tech Mahindra secured \$1.1 billion in new

deals in the quarter, up 33.3 per cent from a year ago.

The company also expanded its large client base by adding three customers in the \$10 million revenue category and four clients generating over \$50 million annually.

MIXED NUMBERS

Wipro reported a mixed set of numbers. Revenue rose 10.6 per cent y-o-y and 1 per cent sequentially to ₹24,479 crore. However, net profit fell 4.7 per cent from the previous quarter to ₹3,352 crore, although it was marginally higher than a year earlier.

The IT major also saw operating margins decline to 16 per cent, down 130 basis points sequentially and marking the company's lowest margin in 15 quarters.

While Wipro retained a higher margin than Tech Mahindra in absolute terms, the contrasting direction of

travel underscored the different trajectories of the two companies.

DEMAND FRONT

On the demand front, Wipro reported total bookings of \$3.37 billion, down 2.4 per cent sequentially in constant currency. However, large deal bookings rose 12.9 per cent q-o-q to \$1.63 billion, suggesting that big-ticket contracts continued to provide support despite a softer overall booking environment.

Looking ahead, Wipro guided for constant currency revenue growth of -1.5 per cent to +0.5 per cent for the September quarter. While the outlook was slightly better than analysts' expectations of a -2 per cent to 0 per cent range, it still points to a cautious demand environment.

With inputs from intern Anya Sapru
Also read **p2**

A Monk Who Trades



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LIC/P1/2026-27/10/Eng

CM

QUICKLY.

Govt hikes windfall tax on export of diesel, ATF



New Delhi: The government has increased the windfall gains tax on exports of diesel and ATF, while lowering the levy on petrol for the fortnight beginning July 16. The rate of Special Additional Excise Duty (SAED) on diesel exports has been increased to ₹15.5 a litre from ₹8.5 a litre. Similarly, SAED on ATF exports has been raised to ₹14.5 per litre from ₹7.5 per litre till July 15. However, the export duty on petrol has been cut to ₹2.5 per litre, from ₹4 per litre. **PTI**

RBI's financial inclusion index rises 4.48% in FY26

Mumbai: Reserve Bank's FI-Index, which captures the extent of financial inclusion in the country, rose 4.48 per cent during the year ending March 2026, the central bank said on Thursday. The RBI had constructed a composite Financial Inclusion Index in consultation with concerned stakeholders, including the government. The annual index was first published in August 2021 for the fiscal year ending March 2021. **PTI**

'Brazil tariff shock flags risks of fast-tracking India-US pact'

TRADE VIGIL. New Delhi watchful as US global tariffs of 10% are set to lapse

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

The US' decision to impose an additional 25 per cent tariff on a broad range of imports from Brazil has reinforced the Indian government's cautious approach towards concluding a bilateral trade agreement with Washington, with trade experts arguing that New Delhi should not rush into a deal amid continuing uncertainty over future US trade actions.

Industry sources said India was adopting a "wait-and-watch" approach as the temporary Section 122 universal tariffs of 10 per cent imposed by the US are scheduled to lapse later this month, potentially bringing those duties down to zero. "At the same time, the outcome of the ongoing Section 301 investigations against India remains uncertain, making it prudent to avoid making fresh market-access commitments before there is greater clarity," a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

ADDITIONAL TARIFF
The latest US decision to impose an additional 25 per



TARIFF SHADOW. Key export sectors could face uncertainty depending on how the US proceeds with the Section 301 investigations on structural excess capacity and forced labour

cent tariff on a wide range of Brazilian imports from July 22 has heightened concerns in India about rushing into a trade deal with Washington.

"This particular Section 301 investigation (against Brazil) was unusually broad. It covered digital trade and Brazil's Pix instant payment system, preferential tariffs granted to India and Mexico, weak anti-corruption enforcement, inadequate intellectual property protection, restrictions on US ethanol exports, and illegal deforestation that allegedly gives Brazilian producers an unfair cost advantage, said Ajay Srivastava from trade research body GTRI.

The Brazil case shows that US trade concerns extend far

beyond tariffs and can cover almost any policy Washington considers discriminatory or commercially disadvantageous, Srivastava said.

"The lesson for India is clear: it cannot meet every US demand. These now range from Russian oil purchases and digital rules to hundreds of trade complaints listed each year in the NTE Report. India should therefore respond calmly to future US actions as they arise, rather than making sweeping concessions through trade deal or outside of it through budget or policy changes to avoid possible investigations or penalties," he said.

Echoing the views, former JNU professor Biswajit Dhar

said the episode demonstrated that trade agreements alone do not necessarily shield countries from unilateral US trade actions.

"India is seeking assurances in the India-US trade deal, which is the right thing to do. But it is absolute clear that the US can always go back and do whatever it wants," Dhar said.

EXPORT SECTORS

According to Dhar, India's key export sectors — including textiles, health products, construction materials, automobiles and auto parts, solar modules, petrochemicals and steel — could all face uncertainty depending on how the US proceeds with the Section 301 investigations on structural excess capacity and forced labour.

"We don't know how much market access we may lose because of additional tariffs as the investigations against India are not yet complete. We have already provided considerable market access to the US even before signing the trade pact, our imports from America have increased and our trade surplus has narrowed. We need to be careful. We cannot give market access for free," he said.

India issues ₹28,000 cr EPC tender for Mahi Banswara nuclear power plant

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India has floated an engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) tender worth more than ₹28,000 crore for the recently inaugurated nuclear power plant project at Mahi Banswara in Rajasthan.

Anushakti Vidhyut Nigam (ASHVINI), a joint venture of the Nuclear Power Corporation of India (NPCIL) and NTPC, released the tender inviting bids for the nuclear island mega EPC package (NIMEP).

"Two-part tender for engineering, design, supply, inspection, testing, packing, forwarding, transportation to site, guarantee, storage, erection, examination, commissioning, operation and maintenance as per the tender specification of Nuclear Island Mega EPC Package (NIMEP) for Mahi Banswara Rajasthan Atomic Power Project, Units-1 to 4, (MBRAPP-1 to 4)," said the bid document.

It has been designed and developed by NPCIL and the project is part of India's broader "fleet mode" initiative, where ten identical 700 MWe reactors are being built across the country under uniform design and procurement plans.

On Tuesday, NPCIL said

COMPREHENSIVE PACKAGE

- This is the largest nuclear island EPC package ever floated for India's indigenous pressurised heavy water reactor programme
- The package covers engineering, manufacturing, supply, civil construction, installation, testing and commissioning assistance of critical nuclear island systems for four pressurised heavy water reactor units of 700 MWe capacity each

on X that ASHVINI, which is also a subsidiary of NPCIL, is set to release the tender inviting bids for the Nuclear Island Mega EPC Package (NIMEP) for the Mahi Banswara Rajasthan Atomic Power Project (MBRAPP) Units 1-4 (4 x 700 megawatt electrical).

CLEAN ENERGY

Estimated at over ₹28,000 crore, this is the largest Nuclear Island EPC packages ever floated for India's indigenous pressurised heavy water reactor (PHWR) programme, it added.

The comprehensive package covers engineering, manufacturing, supply, civil construction, installation, testing and commissioning assistance of critical nuclear island systems for four PHWR units of 700 megawatt electrical (MWe) capacity each.

"The project marks another significant milestone in strengthening India's indigenous nuclear manufac-

turing ecosystem, promoting advanced engineering capabilities, and accelerating the country's clean energy transition. It also presents substantial opportunities for Indian industry to participate in one of the nation's largest nuclear infrastructure initiatives," the NPCIL said.

The tender reinforces the shared commitment towards delivering reliable, low-carbon baseload electricity in support of India's long-term energy security and the national vision of achieving 100 gigawatt (GW) of nuclear power capacity by 2047, it added.

In September last, Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for Ashvini's Mahi Banswara project.

The project, which entails an investment of around ₹42,000 crore, comprises four indigenous 700 MWe PHWRs with advanced safety features, also known as IPHWR 700.

Russia to continue to meet half of India's crude imports in July, Aug

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

India's July 2026 crude oil imports from Russia are expected to at least maintain June's rally when barrels from Moscow accounted for half of New Delhi's monthly shipments as domestic refiners topped up supplies amidst see-sawing geopolitical uncertainty in West Asia.

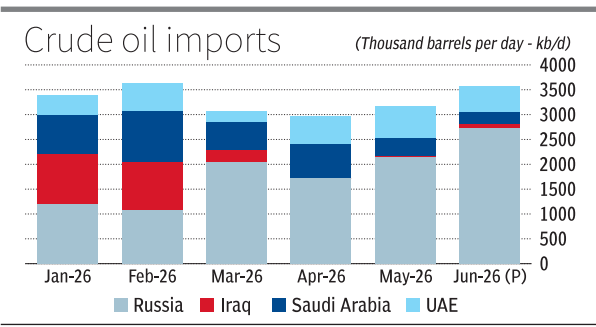
Refiners and traders said that July crude oil imports are likely to follow June's cue as refiners now leverage Russian barrels to hedge against sudden supply disruptions. Besides, cargoes for July mostly would have been booked in the second half of March and April.

"July imports will surpass

5 million barrels per day (mb/d) with Russia accounting for around 2.6-2.7 mb/d. August can also follow the same trajectory as first half supplies are largely done. West Asian producers' share is rising with suppliers using alternate routes such as Sohar port in Oman and the UAE's Fujairah and Khor Fakkan ports. However, they are yet to pick up steam," explained a senior official with a refiner.

Kpler emphasised that Russian crude had become India's strongest energy security hedge, particularly since the SoH disruptions.

Russian barrels have enabled Indian refiners to maintain high refinery run rates, ensure uninterrupted fuel supplies, and avoid the



Source: Kpler (P): Provisional

disruptions experienced by several other Asian refining systems (excluding China), added the real time data and analytics provider.

KEY SUPPLIER

This growing importance is reflected in import trends, emphasised Sumit Ritolia, Kpler's Kpler's Lead Re-

search Analyst for Refining & Modeling. "Russian crude imports rose to around 2.6 mbd in June, accounting for more than 50 per cent of India's crude imports, and have been steadily increasing since March. July arrivals are also tracking at healthy levels and could match or even exceed June's

volumes," he told *businessline*. Currently, Moscow accounts for the majority of India's medium sour grade supply, which dipped at the beginning of 2026 with almost 50 per cent of the crude oil coming from West Asia via the Strait of Hormuz.

However, West Asian share dwindled to roughly 30 per cent from March 2026 onwards as the February 28 attack on Iran by the US led to the latter closing the SoH leading to the largest disruption in energy supplies in history. However, August may also witness some displacement of Russian barrels as Saudi Aramco cut August prices of Arab Light by \$11 a barrel from last month, which is the highest in over two decades. Besides, Saudi

Arabia and the UAE have already increased supply from alternate routes.

For instance, Saudi Arabia is supplying crude oil from the Red Sea port of Yanbu, which is connected through the East-West pipeline that bypasses the SoH. However, a refiner said this route is logistically expensive due to longer travel time to India, which could shift some focus back to Russian crude oil that is available in plenty due to drone attacks on refineries by Ukraine.

"Russian crude remains competitive source of supply for Indian refiners, and under current market conditions, it is difficult to see those volumes disappearing from the system in the near term," Ritolia said.

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Govt hikes cost inflation index for FY27 to 384, lowering long-term capital gains tax

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

Long-term capital gains liability on the sale or transfer of any capital asset, such as land, property, trademarks and patents, is expected to be lower this year as cost inflation index for FY27 has been fixed at 384 as against 376 in FY26, a rise of 2.12 per cent.

The Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) has notified the index. Historically, this index has been the base for adjusting the cost of acquisition of capital assets for inflation while computing long-term capital gains (LTCG), resulting in a more equitable tax outcome.

However, with the withdrawal of indexation benefits under the Finance Act, 2024, its significance has come down, still it will be useful for land or building purchased before July 23, 2024.

"This notification shall apply to the tax year 2026-27 on and from April 1, 2026 and subsequent tax years," it said. The CII number helps determine the LTCG on which an assessee is required to pay taxes.

CII is a way to calculate inflation, that is, an estimated increase in the price of a good or service over the years. Indexation is used to adjust the purchase price of an investment to reflect the effect of inflation on it. A higher purchase price means lesser profits, which effectively means a lower tax.

INDEXATION

With the help of indexation, one will be able to lower her/his LTCG, which brings down taxable income. The rate of inflation to be used for indexation can be obtained from the CII.

The Centre notifies the index. Usually, for the calculation of CII, gains on long-term capital are considered. To benefit the taxpayers, the CII is applied to the long-term capital assets, due to which purchase cost increases, resulting in lesser profits and lesser taxes.

The indexation was in the news in 2023 as the Finance Act removed it for debt mutual funds. From April 1, gains for funds are taxed at the investor's tax slab rates, rather than the previous 20 per cent with indexation benefit and 10 per cent without indexation. As a result, if the investor is subject to the highest tax bracket, this rate would be 35.8 per cent (including surcharge and cess). This mechanism was changed further in 2024. Notably, the concept of indexation using CII was removed in Finance Act 2024 as post July 23, 2024, none of assets were eligible for CII benefit. However, a choice was provided to taxpayers in case of sale of land and building which was acquired prior to July 23, 2024.

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CONSOLIDATED

	REVENUE	EBITDA	PAT
Q1 FY26	11,368	739	406
Q1 FY27	13,381	619	250

STANDALONE

	REVENUE	EBITDA	PAT
Q1 FY26	11,189	675	378
Q1 FY27	12,918	594	248

EXTRACT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30 JUNE 2026

(Amount in millions of ₹ unless otherwise stated)

Particulars	CONSOLIDATED				STANDALONE			
	Quarter Ended		Year Ended		Quarter Ended		Year Ended	
	30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	30.06.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	30.06.2026 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	30.06.2025 (Unaudited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)
Total income from operations (net)	13445.03	11636.00	11420.27	45502.21	12980.42	11199.93	11241.79	44387.55
Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period (before tax and exceptional items)	335.49	311.91	549.47	1909.83	328.45	300.30	506.20	1761.95
Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period before tax (after exceptional items)	335.49	319.70	549.47	2011.18	328.45	302.72	506.20	1857.93
Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax and exceptional items)	249.71	239.44	405.46	1501.38	247.70	230.44	377.58	1397.01
Total Comprehensive income for the period (Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax)	250.19	246.61	402.36	1503.56	248.18	237.24	374.48	1398.81
Equity Share Capital	463.98	463.98	463.98	463.98	463.98	463.98	463.98	463.98
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve as shown in the Balance Sheet of Previous year)				10,569.23				10,174.04
Earning per share (of Rs.5/-each)								
Basic : (Rs.)	2.72	2.60	4.37	16.22	2.67	2.48	4.07	15.05
Diluted : (Rs.)	2.72	2.60	4.37	16.22	2.67	2.48	4.07	15.05

Notes :

- The unaudited financial results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026 were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their meetings held on 16 July 2026.
- The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly Financial Results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Financial Results is available on the Stock exchange website, www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, and on the Company's website, www.heritagefoods.in

Date : 16 July 2026
Place : Tirupati

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
N. BHUVANESWARI
Vice Chairperson and Managing Director
DIN: 00003741

CM YK A CH-CE

QUICKLY.

Laser Power & Infra ends with 23% listing gains



Bengaluru: Laser Power & Infra shares made a strong stock market debut on Thursday. The stock listed at ₹269 on the BSE, a premium of 25.7 per cent over the issue price of ₹214. On the NSE, the stock began trading at ₹250, reflecting a premium of 16.8 per cent. Shares of Laser Power closed at ₹262.42 and at ₹262.85 on the NSE and BSE respectively, a premium of 23 per cent over the IPO price. Earlier, the IPO saw strong demand by getting 39 times subscription as QIBs, NIs and retail investors showed strong interest. Ahead of the IPO, the integrated power cables and transmission products manufacturer raised around ₹223 crore from anchor investors. The IPO comprised a fresh issue worth ₹542 crore and an OFS of ₹200 crore. **OUR BUREAU**

Shriram AMC's refreshed opportunity for 3 funds

Bengaluru: Shriram Asset Management Company Ltd on Thursday announced a refreshed fund opportunity for its three hybrid funds: Shriram Balanced Advantage Fund, Multi Asset Allocation Fund and Aggressive Hybrid Fund. Equity, debt, gold and silver have historically delivered varying levels of risk and return across market cycles. “Since these asset classes are driven by different factors and exhibit relatively low correlation, combining them within a single portfolio can help reduce overall portfolio volatility while offering the potential for reasonable long-term returns,” the AMC said in a release. **OUR BUREAU**

NISM proposes common test for SIF, MF distributors

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

In a major relief for distributors, the National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM) has now introduced a common certification examination for distributors of both mutual funds and Specialised Investment Funds (SIFs), potentially making it easier for large mutual fund distribution networks to venture into the emerging SIF category. The NISM-Series-V-D: Mutual Fund-Specialised Investment Fund Distributors Certification Examination will be available from July 22. It has been designated as the requisite certification standard for individuals involved in the sale and distribution of both MFs and SIFs. Earlier, distributors were finding it difficult to clear the SIF exam as it was much complicated. The development comes even as SIF assets have been growing rapidly with in-

Angel One sees lending, wealth businesses driving next phase of growth

Our Bureau
Mumbai

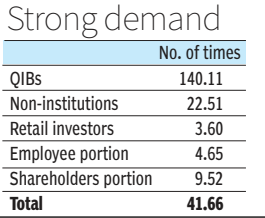
Angel One expects its lending, wealth management and asset management businesses to play a bigger role in growth over the next few quarters, with the company saying nearly 40 per cent of its revenue now comes from businesses outside its core broking operations. Speaking during the company's first quarter earnings call, the management said the business mix is becoming more diversified, helping reduce dependence on trading activity. Broking continues to account for about 60 per cent of gross revenue, while the balance comes from client funding, distribution, depositary services, wealth management and asset management. The company said its client funding book reached a record ₹7,150 crore at the end of the June quarter, while av-

SBI Funds IPO subscribed 42x as QIBs bid aggressively on last day

ALL ROUND INTEREST. ₹9,813 crore public issue receives bids for ₹2.98 lakh crore

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

The SBI Funds Management IPO was subscribed 41.66 times on the final day of bidding, led by strong demand from qualified institutional buyers (QIBs). As against the IPO size of ₹9,813 crore, the offer received bids for ₹2.98 lakh crore. The QIB portion was subscribed 140.11 times and the non-institutional investors category saw subscription of 22.51 times. The retail investor window received bids for 3.60 times, employee quota 4.65 times, and the shareholders portion 9.52 times. The allotment of shares will be finalised on July 17 and the listing is likely to



happen on July 21. Gaurav Garg, Lemonn Markets Desk, said the book received a balanced subscription response. He said the fund house manages money for 18 million retail investors, and it's coming at the cheapest multiple of the lot: 38 times FY26 earnings, against 41.5x for HDFC AMC and 50.9x for Nippon. Although more than half of the ₹29.5 lakh crore it manages is EPFO money, it



yields only 3.5 per cent of revenue. Rest is the ₹5.3 lakh crore active equity book. The IPO is fairly valued and is not cheap as misjudged by only looking at PE numbers, he added.

ANCHOR INVESTORS Ahead of the public issue, SBI Funds Management raised ₹2,663 crore from anchor investors. The anchor book saw participation from global investors including GIC, Abu

Dhabi Investment Authority, Capital World Investors, BlackRock, Fidelity Management & Research, Goldman Sachs Asset Management and Norges Bank. Domestic participants included LIC, HDFC Mutual Fund, ICICI Prudential Mutual Fund, Nippon India Mutual Fund and HDFC Life Insurance. The IPO is entirely an offer-for-sale of 17.09 crore shares and came out with a price band of ₹545-₹574 per share. SBI will sell a 6.3 per cent stake through the issue, while Amundi will divest 3.7 per cent. The issue size was initially proposed at ₹11,693 crore, but was subsequently reduced after the company completed a pre-IPO placement of around ₹1,880 crore.

NSE to launch derivative products on Nifty India FPI 150 Index from August 12

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The National Stock Exchange of India (NSE) has received approval from the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) to launch derivatives on the Nifty India FPI 150 Index. The stock exchange aims to introduce these contracts in the equity derivatives segment from August 12. The exchange will offer 3 serial monthly index futures and index options contract cycle. The cash settled derivatives contracts will expire on the last Tuesday of the expiry month.

Nifty, Sensex hold ground in another volatile session

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The markets ended Thursday's session virtually unchanged, masking a day of sharp intra-day swings driven by geopolitical anxiety, a weakening rupee and elevated crude oil prices. The session was further complicated by the weekly Sensex expiry, which amplified volatility across the board. The Nifty 50 settled at 24,072.75, down just 5.75 points, after swinging between 24,186.50 and 24,050. The BSE Sensex closed at 77,186.87, up a marginal 1.40 points, having touched a high of 77,579.69 and a low of 77,086.42. The Bank Nifty ended weaker, falling 175.60 points or 0.30 per cent to 57,582.25, as private banks sat out the recovery while select PSU banking stocks cushioned the fall.

“Markets remained volatile in the narrow range on the weekly expiry day and closed flat, extending the ongoing consolidation phase,” said Ajit Mishra, SVP Research, Religare Broking. **EMS SHINES** The Nifty Midcap 100 declined around 0.41 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 fell 0.1 per cent, reflecting a cautious undertone beyond the headline indices. Sectorally, Consumer Durables, IT, Chemicals and Media were the standout gainers, with the Electronics Manufacturing Services index rising roughly 3.2 per cent for the second straight session after the Cabinet approved the second phase of the India Semiconductor Mission with an outlay of approximately ₹1.27 lakh crore. On the losing side, realty, banking, financial services, PSU banks, capital markets and metals faced selling pressure.

HSBC ups India equity to neutral

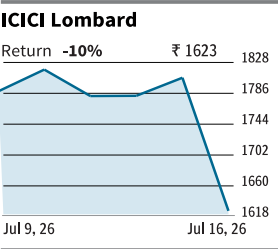
Bloomberg

HSBC Holdings Plc raised Indian equities to ‘neutral’, citing receding risks to earnings from oil prices and strong domestic consumption, reflecting strengthening confidence. The global bank raised its year-end target for the BSE Sensex to 84,000 from 80,500 earlier. “The macro backdrop for India equities has improved quite a bit in recent weeks, mainly because the oil shock faded fast,” strategists led by Herald van der Linde wrote in a note. “We see India as a good way to gain exposure to domestic-oriented growth.” HSBC had downgraded Indian stocks to ‘Underweight’ in April, citing risks to inflation from the Iran war. The shift comes as global funds turn net buyers after a record sell-off this year, with technology-heavy markets such as South Korea facing questions over extreme volatility.

ICICI Lombard plunges 10.6% as weak Q1 results trigger brokerage downgrades

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

ICICI Lombard General Insurance shares slumped 10.5 per cent on Thursday to ₹1,623.80 on the NSE, after several brokerages downgraded the stock post its Q1 results. The company reported a 46 per cent y-o-y fall in net profit to ₹403.17 crore for the first quarter of the current fiscal year. The insurer said earnings were impacted by a ₹165 crore increase in claim reserves in its motor third-party portfolio. Domestic brokerage Motilal Oswal downgraded the stock to ‘Neutral’ from ‘Buy’ and reduced its target price to ₹1,960 from ₹2,210.



The brokerage said competitive intensity remained high in the motor own-damage segment. The company had adopted a conservative reserving approach following a Supreme Court judgment, which impacted claims during the quarter. HSBC downgraded the stock to ‘Hold’ from ‘Buy’ and cut its target price to ₹1,880 from ₹2,200. Citi maintained

its ‘Sell’ rating but raised target price to ₹1,755 from ₹1,735, warning the weak quarter could lead to a multi-year de-rating and highlighted structural challenges in the multi-line non-life insurance space. Morgan Stanley maintained its ‘Equal-weight’ rating with a target price of ₹1,920, saying the June quarter was weak and the earnings outlook was uncertain. However, Macquarie maintained its ‘Outperform’ rating with a target price of ₹2,430. It said multiple headwinds had converged during the quarter, with fire losses and the court judgment weighing on earnings. It added that conservative reserves offered protection as competition intensified.

BROKER'S CALL.

Motilal Oswal Research

BILLIONBRAINS GARAGE (BUY) Target: ₹250 CMP: ₹205.65 Billionbrains Garage Ventures (Groww) reported an operating revenue of ₹1,500 crore in Q1FY27, reflecting a growth of 66 per cent year-on-year (in line). Operating expenses rose 26 per cent to ₹530 crore in Q1FY27 (14 per cent below estimate), with employee expenses increasing 33 per cent (in line) and other expenses increasing 23 per cent (19 per cent below estimate). EBITDA doubled to ₹970 crore, reflecting an EBITDA margin of 64.6 per cent. PAT for the quarter came in at ₹740 crore, growing 94 per cent. As established businesses continue to gain operating leverage and new products are largely being built by existing teams, the management expects the overall cost structure to remain relatively stable. Groww continues to report strong revenue growth, backed by rising user adoption of products as well as robust user activation. Its brokerage business is gaining market share across segments, with recent product launches, fuelling further growth. We expect the overall orders in the broking segment to report over 20 per cent growth over FY27-28, backed by market share expansion and improving revenue per order. We have largely maintained our top-line estimates, with lower cash and derivatives revenue being offset by higher MTF revenue. We have increased our earnings estimates by 1 per cent/3 per cent for FY27-28, considering the improved operational efficiency. We reiterate our BUY rating with a revised TP of ₹250 (premised on 38x FY28E EPS).

HDFC Securities

UNION BANK OF INDIA (ADD) Target: ₹200 CMP: ₹168.80 Union Bank of India's earnings were higher than our estimates on the back of NIM reflation and improving operating leverage. Loan growth (+13.3 per cent year-on-year) sustained the improving trajectory (Q1FY26: 8 per cent), although it remains below system-wide growth trends (+16-17 per cent). The bank is re-scaling its loan book over the past two quarters with aspirations for higher loan growth. Deposit mobilisation has been relatively subdued (+3.5 per cent), with greater focus on CASA (35.1 per cent) and retail term deposits, as per the management. The focus on improving the quality of deposits (granular retail deposits) alongside higher deposit mobilisation is becoming a challenge, translating into higher C/D ratio. While FCNR deposits and liquidity management could provide near-term respite on margins, structurally higher funding costs, softer treasury income and upward normalisation of credit costs are likely to keep the earnings growth muted. We expect credit costs to average 51 bps during FY27-28E, owing to rising stress in the MSME portfolio and pick-up in credit growth. Asset quality remained steady in a seasonally-weak quarter as the bank made an additional provisioning buffer of ₹100 crore, factoring in global macros. Given it is gradually getting back on the growth runway, margin-accretive growth will be critical alongside higher deposit mobilisation, while maintaining the quality of deposits. We maintain ADD with an unchanged TP of ₹200 (1.0x March 2028 ABVPS).

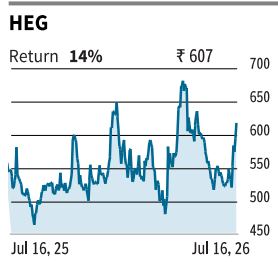
businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: **blmarketwatch@gmail.com**

TODAY'S PICK.

HEG (₹607.95): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The short-term outlook is bullish for HEG. The stock has been moving inside a bull channel for more than a year now. After consolidating above the lower end of this channel for over a month, the stock has risen sharply this week. The 11 per cent surge this week indicates that the upmove has gained momentum. Cluster of support is in the ₹560-₹540 region. HEG share price can rise to ₹710, the upper end of the channel, in the coming weeks. Traders can buy HEG shares now at ₹608. Accumulate on dips at ₹570. Keep the stop-loss at ₹530



initially. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹625 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹640. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹645 and ₹670 when the price touches ₹660 and ₹690 respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹710. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

24100 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23970	23900	24200	24300	Go long on dips at 24020 and 23980 with a stop-loss at 23920

₹808 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
806	790	812	820	Take fresh shorts below 806. Keep the stop-loss at 808

₹1084 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1075	1055	1100	1120	Go short only below 1075. Keep the stop-loss at 1080

₹280 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
277	275	281	285	Go long only above 281. Stop-loss can be kept at 279

₹246 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
245	243	248	250	Stuck in a narrow range. Avoid trading this stock now

₹1300 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1285	1270	1310	1330	Take fresh shorts below 1285 with a stop-loss at 1290

₹1030 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1025	1010	1035	1045	Go short only below 1025. Keep the stop-loss at 1030

₹2199 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2175	2150	2245	2300	Go short on a break below 2175. Keep the stop-loss at 2185

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers					▼ 5.75 pts.
	Close(f)	Pts	PE	WN%	
Bajaj Finance	1037.60	9.54	33.42	2.52	
M&M	3117.80	6.81	20.82	2.53	
Maruti Suzuki	13783.00	5.70	29.52	1.63	
TCS	279.35	5.68	16.65	2.44	
Int'lGlobeWii	5265.50	4.67	0.00	1.08	
Infosys	1082.40	4.67	14.90	3.44	
HCL Tech	1187.40	4.47	18.48	1.14	
Titan	4625.80	4.18	80.94	1.73	
ICICI Bank	1418.20	3.32	17.56	9.22	
TCS	2201.00	2.83	15.00	2.84	
Bharti Airtel	1921.80	2.13	34.62	5.30	
Wipro	1177.74	1.94	14.07	0.46	
Reliance Ind	1296.60	1.62	18.32	7.95	
Tech Mahindra	1510.30	1.61	30.80	0.87	
Hindalco	959.30	1.11	16.10	1.26	
State Bank	1031.20	0.99	10.98	3.87	
Asian Paints	2674.70	0.46	58.38	1.10	
TataConsumerProduct	1088.50	0.43	69.64	0.64	
Eicher Motors	7418.50	0.42	36.92	0.93	
Tata Steel	185.49	0.42	21.27	1.39	
Bajaj Auto	10331.50	0.21	27.31	1.04	
Adani Enter	3151.40	0.05	41.20	0.83	
PowerGrid Corp	280.75	0.05	16.39	1.15	
Coal India	427.35	-0.10	8.48	0.93	
NestleIndia	1423.50	-0.14	78.45	0.93	
HDFC Life	567.60	-0.27	64.05	0.55	
Sun Pharma	1950.10	-0.32	40.66	1.87	
ONGC	246.75	-0.36	6.23	0.87	
Adani Ports	1826.40	-0.44	22.92	1.22	
Tata Motors PV	331.10	-0.55	4073.17	2.63	
Trent Ltd.	2860.20	-0.55	88.61	0.86	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	235.65	-0.67	99.69	0.70	
Dr Reddys Lab	1224.40	-0.68	24.58	0.68	
Max Healthcare	1098.20	-0.73	74.10	0.74	
Hind Unilever	2098.40	-0.81	46.59	1.69	
Apollo Hosp	180.75	-1.02	63.47	0.83	
Cipla	1429.50	-1.04	29.90	0.73	
UltraTech Cement	11771.00	-1.06	42.36	1.26	
Grasim Ind	3072.90	-1.09	20.30	1.05	
JSW Steel	1221.00	-1.21	11.71	1.04	
Bajaj Finserv	1838.60	-1.39	14.96	0.97	
NTPC	342.45	-1.97	12.05	1.47	
Kotak Bank	377.15	-2.01	19.45	2.52	
L&T	3775.60	-2.12	27.40	4.01	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1024.40	-2.88	24.04	1.30	
Axis Bank	1307.60	-2.95	15.32	3.41	
Bharat Elec	407.10	-3.01	49.09	0.32	
SBI Life	1822.10	-4.35	73.99	0.74	
Etelnet Ltd.	236.45	-13.13	755.26	1.98	
HDFC Bank	808.30	-23.91	15.71	11.23	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▼ 252.05 pts.

	Close(f)	Pts	PE	WN%
Abb India	7667.50	71.21	102.83	1.64
Siemens	3657.60	22.23	84.98	1.32
SamvardmathersonInternat	143.65	19.94	37.11	2.59
Indian Oilcorp	141.80	17.08	4.58	2.16
Cummins India	5592.00	16.83	65.63	3.08
Divis Lab	7316.00	16.02	75.63	3.79
Bpcl	312.00	14.26	5.24	2.58
Macrotech Developers .	1178.10	12.76	34.31	1.33
Adani Energy Solutions .	1689.50	11.07	84.82	2.26
Avenuesuper	3550.90	10.20	84.28	2.60
Varun Beverages .	466.55	9.42	49.17	2.60
Hyundai Motor India .	2025.00	9.24	30.29	1.18
Solar Industries	18400.00	8.21	95.88	1.83
Hindustanaeronautics	4433.80	7.39	32.53	3.43
United Spirits .	1381.60	7.10	53.82	1.66
Godrej Consumer	1057.70	5.89	58.14	1.73
Shree Cement	2700.00	2.94	55.71	1.47
LtMinttree	4060.30	2.64	23.18	1.54
Bank Of Baroda	248.30	0.82	6.40	1.88
Britannia Ind	5310.50	-1.73	50.42	2.55
Mazagon Dock	2361.30	-1.80	34.57	0.73
ZydlusHeslences	1153.90	-2.20	22.66	1.18
Indian Railway Finance Corp	355.90	-2.20	84.28	2.60
Ambuja Cements	433.60	-2.91	19.60	2.10
Punjab Natl Bank	105.22	-4.95	6.55	1.48
Canara Bank	125.90	-5.61	6.39	1.72
Muthootfin	2996.10	-6.32	11.34	1.31
Rural Elec	349.60	-7.69	5.64	1.78
Hindus Zinc	521.95	-8.17	15.94	1.02
Pidlittind	1559.60	-8.35	64.25	1.97
Bosch	41110.00	-8.52	43.72	1.45
Torrent Pharma	4987.60	-9.29	78.95	2.13
Gail (India)	171.71	-11.38	14.89	1.89
AdaniGreenenergy	1543.70	-11.50	127.97	2.11
Tata Capital	349.35	-12.17	30.32	0.72
Vedanta	257.90	-13.17	6.36	1.78
Bajaj Holdings	10417.00	-14.47	11.34	1.84
Coal India & Ind Sol	371.95	-14.47	12.13	3.30
Indial Steel	1028.00	-15.42	31.20	1.55
Dlf	68.14	-18.14	3.34	1.69
Power Finance	401.35	-18.35	3.94	2.38
Tata Power	378.17	-18.58	23.55	2.56
Cholamandamini&Fin	1749.10	-18.76	29.15	3.16
Coal India	388.77	-20.44	6.63	3.33
Siemens EnergyIndia .	3805.30	-23.87	92.59	1.23
Adani Power	216.57	-29.19	30.20	3.66
Indian Hotels Co .	71.15	-30.24	46.33	2.62
Tvs Motor Cmp .	3563.50	-33.60	53.13	3.41
Tata Motors Cv	412.55	-47.33	50.17	3.51
Indic Ams	2602.20	-75.89	39.03	2.16

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Waaree commissions
15 GWh BESS facility

Ahmedabad: Waaree Energies Ltd on Wednesday said its subsidiary, Waaree Energy Storage Solutions has commenced operations at its advanced Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) container manufacturing facility at Rola, Gujarat, marking the first milestone in its planned 20 GWh integrated energy storage manufacturing roadmap. The facility has an annual capacity of 5.15 GWh, upgraded from the planned 3.5 GWh through production de-bottlenecking and improved battery cell energy density. It will cater to utility-scale and commercial and industrial applications, the company stated in a release. **OUR BUREAU**

ACME Solar secures
₹2,647 cr REC funding

Ahmedabad: ACME Solar Holdings said it has secured ₹2,646.64 crore in long-term project financing from REC Ltd for its 450 MW/1,800 MWh Assured Peak Power (firm and dispatchable renewable energy) project. The funding, raised by ACME Greentech Seventh, will be used for the development and construction of the project, the company said in a statement. REC will be the sole lender for the project, with the loan having a tenure of 20 years. **OUR BUREAU**

Semicon 2.0 will make India
a global hub, say experts

SECTOR LIFT. Industry expects investment, R&D, domestic value addition to accelerate

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

The approval of the next phase of the Semicon India Programme (Semicon2.0), with an outlay of ₹27 lakh crore, has the potential to position India not just as a manufacturing destination, but as a globally competitive hub for semiconductor innovation, said analysts and industry veterans.

The Cabinet on Wednesday approved the policy under the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM) to accelerate the development of a robust semiconductor ecosystem.

INDUSTRY CATALYST
“Semicon 2.0 marks a decisive step in India’s journey from policy intent to execution at scale. Phase 1 established India’s credibility; Phase 2 builds long-term capability. By strengthening ATMP/OSAT packaging, R&D, and talent development, each backed by incentives of up to 75 per cent under the design and R&D pillars, the government is creating the full-spectrum support our industry has been advocating for and



TECH LEAP. With an outlay of ₹1.27 lakh crore, Semicon 2.0 seeks to strengthen India’s global semiconductor footprint

foundation for a globally competitive ecosystem that will attract sustained investments, create high-value employment and enhance domestic value addition,” Ashok Chandak, President, India Electronics and Semiconductor Association IESA and SEMI India (Indian arm of the global semiconductor industry association), said.

He said Semicon 2.0 comes at an opportune time, as the global semiconductor industry is entering an unprecedented investment cycle. “With worldwide semiconductor manufacturing equipment spending expected to grow to nearly \$230 billion by 2028, the policy positions India to capture the next wave of global

investments,” he added. According to IESA, the ISM 2.0 is also expected to attract another \$40–50 billion in investments, create 2–3 lakh high-skilled jobs, significantly strengthen India’s position as a trusted global semiconductor partner.

With complementary initiatives such as the Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS), Production Linked Incentive (PLI), Electronics Manufacturing Clusters (EMC 2.0) and State programmes, Semicon 2.0 has the potential to accelerate India’s journey towards nearly 40 per cent domestic value addition in electronics manufacturing, it added.

Pankaj Mohindroo, Chairman, India Cellular & Electronics Association (ICEA), said India has demonstrated the intent and long-term commitment to the industry with more than 12 approved projects in just four years, under ISM 1.0 and ISM 2.0 now builds on this strong foundation with an emphasis on design, R&D, capital goods, and the entire supply chain and skill development.

“This reflects the government’s long-term vision to build capabilities that are relevant to global supply chains and position India as a consequential player in the global semiconductor industry. Forward-looking State governments will now fiercely compete for investments to get a share of ISM 2.0. Semiconductor design, including AI compute with IP owned by Indian companies, will be a focus area,” Mohindroo said.

Aisha Ali Hussaini, Semiconductor Tax Partner at EY India, said, “With anchor investments secured in fabrication & packaging and commercial production now underway, India has moved decisively from ambition to execution.”

British Airways’ ground handling
receipts are taxable in India: ITAT

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Delhi Bench of the Income Tax Appellate Tribunal declined to give relief to British Airways on tax benefits under the Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement (DTAA) for services provided to other airlines in India.

Experts opined that other airlines from the UK will face a similar issue, while there would be relief for airlines from Germany and the Netherlands.

POOLING DISPUTE

The Bench highlighted that, as per the contention of British Airways, the ground handling and engineering services rendered by it to other airlines in India are ancillary to the main activity of operating aircraft in India, and such ancillary services fall under a pooling activity. Hence, the revenue generated from rendering of such services deserves the benefit of the India-UK DTAA.

“We find that the issue raised by the assessee in the present appeal is a legacy issue, the assessee was denied treaty benefit on the revenue generated from such pooling activity for the first time in AY 1996-97 and thereafter in subsequent assessment



CAP ON RELIEF. Article 8 interpretation limits tax exemption for UK airlines’ ancillary service revenues

years, the revenue has consistently denied benefit of Article 8 of the India-UK DTAA on receipts from rendering of ground handling and engineering services to other airlines in India,” the Bench said.

TREATY CONTRAST

Outlining that the assessee has tried to draw parity between its own case and Delhi HC decisions in KLM Royal Dutch Airlines and Lufthansa German Airlines, the bench specified that the High Court had categorically held that the provisions of Article 8 of the DTAA are not *pari materia* to the provisions of Article 8 of the India-Germany/Netherlands DTAA.

Further, it opined that it is a well-accepted proposition

that OECD commentary is not a binding precedent.

Sandeep Sehgal, Partner-Tax at AKM Global, said this correctly underscores that treaty benefits under Article 8 of the India-UK DTAA are strictly confined to profits from the operation of aircraft in international traffic. Unlike the India-Germany and India-Netherlands treaties, which contain an express pooling clause, the UK treaty is narrower. The Tribunal has rightly distinguished the Delhi High Court decisions on KLM and Lufthansa on this precise ground — the High Court had observed that the UK provision is not *pari materia*.

While airlines may view ground-handling and engineering services to other carriers as commercially ancillary to their international operations, the plain language of the India-UK DTAA does not extend the exemption.

“The issue having attained finality in British Airways’ own cases since AY 1996-97, the ruling reinforces that treaty interpretation remains text-driven and jurisdiction-specific. UK airlines (and others with similarly worded Article 8) will continue to face Indian tax on such receipts, while German and Dutch carriers enjoy a broader shield,” Sehgal said.

Govt targets 25% food processing
levels by 2031, seeks investments

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The Union government is aiming to increase overall levels of food processing to 25 per cent by 2031 from 17 per cent in 2023, Food Processing Secretary Avinash Joshi said on Thursday.

Noting that the PLI scheme for the food processing sector has been one of the most successful schemes, he added that the Ministry is looking at other measures to encourage enhanced investments in the sector. He also urged the industry to ensure compliance with food safety regulations and to promote healthier choices and responsible processing practices.

SECTOR’S GROWTH

Referring to a recent Crisil report, Joshi said that the country’s processing levels have increased from about 10 per cent in 2010-11 to 17 per cent in 2023. “Internally, we have a target to increase it to at least 25 per cent by 2031. An increase in the processing level would help in value addition, boost exports



GROWTH PUSH. Industry-led interventions are planned to boost exports across key segments

and also create a lot of positives for the primary, secondary, as well as the tertiary sector market,” he added.

“A few days back, we had the opportunity to talk to the Prime Minister. So there, we said that to take this processing level to 25 per cent at least, we need some national processing mission or PLI 2.0 or whatever name we give to the scheme, because this sector needs enhanced investment in a very short period of time,” Joshi said while speaking at a FICCI event.

BHARAT BRAND

He also stressed the need to develop facilities that help export promotion and im-

port substitution, especially in segments such as edible oils that require a scalable transformation. “One more thing that the government has started working on is to create a Bharat brand for processed food. What we are planning to do through this Bharat brand platform is to give visibility to Indian cuisines and Indian alcoholic beverages. Today, we are exporting a lot of ready-to-eat and processed food which caters largely to the Indian diaspora, but it’s important to start thinking of global consumers for scalable transformation,” he added.

Talking about the PLI scheme, which is being implemented with a total financial outlay of ₹10,900 crore, Joshi said it has been one of the most successful schemes as it has achieved all targets in terms of employment generation, committed investments, exports and value addition.

He added that the Ministry is conceptualising interventions based on consultations with the industry to ensure that the food processing sector is placed at the forefront of development.

‘We plan to double ore output with ₹1,200 cr investment’

bl interview

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Indian Metals and Ferro Alloys consolidated its position as India’s leading ferrochrome producer with the acquisition of Tata Steel’s unit in Odisha.

The company will soon commission the first furnace of its planned 1 lakh tonnes greenfield project.

While the overall cost of production has increased, firm ferrochrome prices have helped the company to protect its profit margin.

Subhrakant Panda, Managing Director, Indian Metals and Ferro Alloys, spoke about the company’s expansion plans, market dynamics and growth outlook.

Edited excerpts:

Have you integrated the recently acquired Tata Steel ferrochrome business with your operations?

Yes. We are setting up a 1 lakh tonne greenfield ferrochrome plant at Kalinganagar and expect to commission the first furnace in the next couple of weeks. The Tata Steel unit



Over 90 per cent of our production has been exported, primarily to the Far East

SUBHRAKANT PANDA
MD, Indian Metals and Ferro Alloys



we acquired is located right across the road from the new plant, creating significant operational and administrative synergies.

Over the past three years, we have embarked on a major capacity expansion. We aim to double chrome ore mining output to 12 lakh tonnes (lt) annually, crossing 10 lt this fiscal, while expanding ferrochrome capacity from 2.6 lt to over 5 lt.

The acquired Tata Steel plant adds 1 lakh tonnes of capacity, with another 50,000 tonnes expected by mid-2027 after completion of a partially built furnace. The greenfield plant being commissioned this month will contribute an additional 1 lt.

Once all these projects are completed, our installed

ferrochrome capacity will exceed 5 lt a year. We expect ferrochrome production to rise to about 4 lt in FY27 from 2.65 lt last year — an increase of over 50 per cent. For FY28, we are targeting 4.75-5 lt, while chrome ore mining is expected to peak at 12 lt annually by FY31.

On the energy front, we operate a 200 MW coal-based power plant and 4.5 MW of solar capacity.

We have also tied up 135 MW of hybrid renewable power with JSW Energy and Enfinity Global.

Supply from the JSW project is expected to begin in August, while the Enfinity project will come on stream next year.

Together, these projects should meet 35-40 per cent of our total power require-

ment through renewable energy.

How is the demand for ferrochrome amid the rally in prices?

Ferrochrome prices have increased from about ₹1.10 lakh per tonne to about ₹1.25 lakh per tonne due to supply constraints.

Over 90 per cent of our production has been exported, primarily to the Far East.

However, we expect this ratio to shift to about 60:40 by next year due to increasing domestic demand. We are relatively insulated from the West Asia crisis, as we do not do business there.

How secure is your chrome ore supply?

Our mining leases are valid until 2049 and 2055.

We are increasing ore production to 12 lt annually with an investment of ₹1,200 crore. We are transitioning from open-cast mining to underground mining.

With underground mining, infrastructure for peak planned capacity must be built from the outset.

Unlike open-cast mines, you cannot simply add another excavator later to increase production.

We are continuing exploration activities to determine whether we can increase production beyond the currently planned 12 lt.

Will the rally in ferrochrome prices sustain?

Supply constraints persist, though developments in South Africa warrant close monitoring.

Home to the world’s largest chrome ore reserves, South Africa was once the leading ferrochrome producer before ceding the position to China due to rising inland logistics costs and higher electricity tariffs.

South Africa has recently cut power tariffs for two ferrochrome producers — Glencore and Samancor. As domestic ferrochrome production declined, chrome ore exports rose.

China, despite having no chrome ore reserves, increased ferrochrome output from about 6.5 lakh tonnes a month to 9.5 lakh tonnes using entirely imported ore.

If lower power tariffs revive South African ferrochrome production, chrome ore exports could decline, limiting China’s output and helping maintain market balance.

Agri-tech platform Rize
secures \$31 m in Series B funding

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Rize, a Singapore-headquartered agri-tech platform, on Thursday announced the close of a \$31 million Series B funding round, comprising \$20 million in equity and \$11 million in debt financing. The round brings together a coalition of climate-focused and development finance investors who intend to help scale Rize’s model across Vietnam, Indonesia and the wider region.

The equity raise is led by BNP Paribas Asset Management Alts, and joined by The Rockefeller Foundation, alongside existing investors Temasek and Breakthrough Energy Ventures. Debt financing is catalysed by BIDV, Temasek Foundation, and UOB. This brings Rize’s total funding to date to \$47 million, and will be deployed across export expansion, AI-powered tools for farmers and field teams, carbon and innovation initiatives and organisational growth. In the two years since its Series A, Rize has scaled operations more than ten-fold.

Dr Reddy’s sharpens focus on value
through differentiated offerings

G Naga Sridhar
Hyderabad

Dr Reddy’s Laboratories will continue to strengthen its base business while building future growth drivers across peptides, biosimilars, consumer healthcare, and innovation-led therapies, according to its Chairman K Satish Reddy and Co-Chairman and Managing Director GV Prasad.

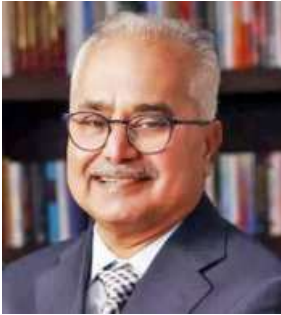
In their message to the shareholders in the annual report for the year 2025-26, the top leadership of the companies said: “Our focus remains on consistent execution, disciplined capital allocation, and improving the quality and sustainability of our performance.”

ONCOLOGY PIPELINE

The Hyderabad-based company’s oncology subsidiary, Aurigene Oncology, is advancing multiple programmes, with three assets currently in clinical development and several promising candidates in pre-clinical development. Efforts were on to build a differentiated global oncology business through a



K Satish Reddy, Chairman



GV Prasad, Co-Chairman & MD

combination of internal innovation and partnerships, they said.

In APIs and services, competitive pressures persist as customers increasingly move towards backward integration. “In response, we are sharpening our focus on value through differentiated offerings and expanding our Contract Development and Manufacturing Organisation (CDMO) capabilities via Aurigene Pharmaceutical Services Ltd (APSL) to drive sustainable growth,” the leaders said.

GROWTH DRIVER

In FY26, the API and North America generics businesses of Dr Reddy’s faced in-

creased competitive intensity even as the biosimilars business was at an inflection point, they said, adding: “We are taking focused steps to scale it into a meaningful growth driver.”

STRATEGIC PRIORITIES

The company’s strategy would remain anchored in three priorities: strengthening core generics and API businesses through differentiated launches, targeted R&D, and supply chain reliability; expanding stable value pools through our consumer health portfolio; and building innovation-led growth platforms through selective partnerships and licensing, they added.

Robust festival demand fails to offset margin
pressure for automakers as input costs bite

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Automobile makers are entering the festival season with healthy demand, but their biggest challenge is no longer selling more vehicles — it is protecting profitability.

The rupee at a record-low of 96.34 against the US dollar and a sharp rise in commodity prices are driving up costs just as manufacturers ramp up production for the busiest sales period.

Lithium carbonate prices have surged 158 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y), cobalt 78 per cent, copper 38 per cent and aluminium 37 per cent, increasing the cost of components.

The pressure is already visible in earnings expectations. Nuvama Institutional Equities expects aggregate revenue in the sector under its coverage to grow 22 per cent y-o-y this quarter, but projects EBITDA growth of only 10 per cent, indicating that rising input costs will weigh on margins despite robust demand.

Unlike earlier commodity cycles driven by steel or



COMMODITY SHOCK. Soaring raw material costs are driving up manufacturing expenses across conventional and EVs

crude oil, the current inflation is broad-based, affecting almost every major raw material used.

Aluminium, zinc and steel are raising body and structural costs, while copper is increasing the cost of wiring harnesses, electric motors and electronics.

Battery economics have worsened as lithium and cobalt prices soar, while engineering plastics, rubber chemicals and carbon black have also become costlier.

EVs UNDER PRESSURE

The weaker rupee has compounded the problem because many of these materials are imported or globally priced, making every dollar-

denominated purchase costlier.

Electric-vehicle makers face the biggest challenge as EVs use significantly more copper and rely heavily on imported battery materials, cells and power electronics.

Along with lithium carbonate’s 158 per cent jump, lithium hydroxide has risen 135 per cent and cobalt 78 per cent, increasing battery costs at a time when manufacturers are trying to improve affordability.

Morgan Stanley expects stronger demand to help recover part of these costs, but believes EV-heavy manufacturers will face greater near-term pressure.

The impact will vary

across companies. Tata Motors has the highest exposure to imported battery cells and power electronics, making localisation efforts such as the Agratas battery programme increasingly important.

Mahindra & Mahindra enters the cycle with stronger margins from its premium SUV business, giving it more flexibility to absorb higher costs while expanding its electric vehicle portfolio.

Maruti Suzuki has lower exposure to battery metals because of its gradual EV rollout, although higher prices continue to affect its mass-market models. Its high localisation levels and procurement scale provide some cushion.

Analysts expect the sustained rise in costs to accelerate localisation of components while prompting manufacturers to renegotiate supplier contracts and improve material efficiency.

If the rupee remains weak and commodity prices stay elevated, calibrated vehicle price increases across both internal-combustion and electric models are increasingly likely, analysts added.

QUICKLY.

HCLTech to acquire
Guardian India for \$10.5 m

New Delhi: HCLTech on Thursday announced the acquisition of Guardian India operations for \$10.5 million (about ₹101 crore), a deal that will see nearly 2,000 employees of the US-based firm transition to the tech giant under a seven-year partnership with Guardian Life Insurance. HCLTech will acquire a 100 per cent stake in the entity. **■**

Elgi Equipments receives
₹25 cr US tariff refunds

Chennai: Elgi Equipments informed the exchanges on Thursday that its wholly owned subsidiary, Elgi Compressors USA INC, has received a tariff refund from US Customs and Border Protection amounting to \$2.68 million, equivalent to approximately ₹25.6 crore. The company said this is consequent to the US Supreme Court’s directives to the US government to refund the excess tariff collected from importers. **OUR BUREAU**

5 Bills, including on development of MSMEs, listed for Monsoon Session

IN DEFENCE. One of the Bills relates to the prevention of insults to national honour

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The government has listed five Bills, including one for the development of micro, small and medium enterprises (MSME) and one related with the prevention of insults to national honour, the daily bulletin of the Lok Sabha showed on Thursday.

Along with these, it has also listed a Bill that prescribes setting up single regulatory commission for higher education for consideration and passage after a Parliamentary panel gives its report. However, there is no mention of Delimitation Bill.

According to the bulletin, The Income-tax (Amendment) Bill will be introduced to replace an Ordinance. The Ordinance, promulgated last month, exempted foreign portfolio investors, overseas investors, and the Bank for



MISSING. There is no mention of the Delimitation Bill

International Settlements from capital gains tax on interest and trading gains from government bonds. Retrospective from April 1, the move replaces the previous regime where short-term capital gains were taxed at 30 per cent and long-term capital gains on sovereign securities stood at 12.5 per cent.

The Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, seeks to align the 2006 Act with changing MSME landscape, to enhance the ease of doing business and bring

trust-based regulations in the MSME ecosystem.

Further, it aims to strengthen the mechanism for addressing delayed payments, provide for enforcement of arbitral awards for the MSMEs, and to introduce flexibility and create enabling provisions for States to decide composition of Micro and Small Enterprises Facilitation Council (MSEFC) thereby forming more MSEFCs.

Another new Bill, the Registration of Births and Deaths (Amendment) Bill,

2026 aims to amend its parent act to make provisions of delayed registration more stringent. Also, in order to replace another ordinance, the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, which will be introduced, prescribes increasing the number of Judges in the Supreme Court from the present 33 to 37 (excluding the Chief Justice of India).

EDUCATION PUSH

The Lok Sabha is also scheduled to take up the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan Bill after it vetted by the Joint Committee. The Bill provides for repealing the University Grants Commission Act, 1956, the All-India Council for Technical Education Act, 1987 and the National Council for Teacher Education Act, 1993. These institutions to be replaced by Viksit Bharat Shiksha Adhishthan along with the

three Councils, namely, the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Viniyaman Parishad (the Regulatory Council), the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Gunvatta Parishad (the Accreditation Council) and the Viksit Bharat Shiksha Manak Parishad (the Standards Council).

These three will “enable and empower universities and other higher educational institutions to achieve excellence in teaching, learning, research and innovation, as an outcome of better co-ordination and determination of standards in institutions for higher education or research and scientific and technical institutions,” statement and object of the Bill said.

Legislative agenda also includes consideration and passage of “The Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill”, introduced during the Budget session.

US tightens visa rules for students, journalists

Reuters
Washington

The Trump administration moved on Thursday to tighten the duration of visas for foreign students, cultural exchange visitors and journalists, according to a government notice.

The new final rule from the Department of Homeland Security creates a fixed time period for F visas for international students, J visas that allow visitors on cultural exchange programmes to work in the US, and I visas for members of the media. Those visas are currently available for the duration of the programme or US-based employment.

The effective date is 60 days from publication in the federal register, subject to congressional review. President Donald Trump kicked off a wide-ranging immigration crackdown after taking office in January 2025. The latest action would create new hurdles for international students, exchange workers and foreign journalists. The Trump administra-



tion has increased scrutiny of legal immigration, revoking student visas and green cards of university students over their ideological views and stripping legal status from hundreds of thousands of migrants.

SHORTENED STAY

Under the new regulation, the student and exchange visa periods would be no longer than four years. The visa for journalists, which currently can last years, would be up to 240 days or, in the case of Chinese nationals, 90 days.

The visa holders could apply for extensions, it said. The department cited a dramatic rise in such visas in the posting. It said there were more than 1.8 million student visa admissions in 2024, a more than 11 per cent rise over the previous year.

Renault taps Korea turnaround playbook for India as Deblaise, Goyal discuss €2 b export push

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Fresh from leading Renault’s turnaround in South Korea, Renault India CEO and Managing Director Stéphane Deblaise is bringing a similar playbook to India after meeting Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal to discuss advanced manufacturing, localisation, exports and electric and hybrid mobility.

The discussions come as Renault pursues its FutuReady India strategy, targeting €2 billion in exports and aiming to make India one of the Group’s three largest global manufacturing, engineering and export hubs by 2030.

Sharing details of the meeting, Goyal said discussions focused on “expanding advanced manufacturing, deepening localisation, and strengthening India’s position as a global hub for automotive innovation and electric & hybrid mobility.”

Deblaise said the two sides exchanged views on Renault’s “FutuReady India plan to export €2 billion.”



Union Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal (right) in a discussion with Renault India CEO Stéphane Deblaise (middle)

“We discussed the evolving opportunities for manufacturing, innovation, exports and the role of policy in strengthening India’s competitiveness as a global automotive and engineering hub,” he said.

SEVEN MODELS

Renault’s India revival is anchored around its largest-ever product offensive. The company plans to launch seven new models and 22 variants by 2030, including the next-generation Duster, new SUVs, expanded CNG offerings and its first locally manufactured mass-market electric vehicle.

The strategy is aimed at raising Renault’s passenger-vehicle market share to

around 5 per cent by 2030 from below 1 per cent currently, while strengthening its presence in the fast-growing B- and C-segment SUV market.

The Renault Group Entry Platform will underpin updated versions of the Kwid, Kiger and Tribler, including factory-fitted CNG variants, while the Renault Group Modular Platform will support future SUVs with internal-combustion, hybrid and battery-electric powertrains. The common-architecture approach is expected to reduce development costs while allowing Renault to respond to changing customer demand and tighter emission regulations.

Deblaise, who led Renault

Korea’s turnaround by modernising the Busan plant, strengthening exports and repositioning the business around higher-value SUVs, is now applying a similar strategy in India after Renault’s market share slipped below 1 per cent.

CHENNAI HUB

A key enabler is Renault’s acquisition of Nissan’s remaining 51 per cent stake in the Chennai manufacturing joint venture, giving the French automaker full ownership of the facility. The move gives Renault greater control over investments, localisation, supplier development and exports while integrating manufacturing and engineering under a single operating structure.

Rather than betting exclusively on battery-electric vehicles, Renault will pursue a multi-energy strategy spanning internal-combustion, hybrid and battery-electric models, positioning Chennai as a flexible production and export base as India assumes a larger role in Renault’s global manufacturing network.

Gates MRI, Serum Institute ink pact to manufacture novel TB vaccine

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Gates Medical Research Institute (Gates MRI) and Serum Institute of India Private Ltd (SII) have agreed to manufacture a novel tuberculosis (TB) vaccine candidate. And SII expects to invest more than \$100 million in strengthening its manufacturing readiness and capacity building to support potential future supply, they said in a joint communication.

The vaccine is undergoing Phase III clinical trial, and has the potential to be the first new TB vaccine to be introduced in more than a century, the communication said.

This partnership ensures that the vaccine, if approved, can be produced at scale and made available to adults and adolescents in countries with a high TB burden as soon as possible. “SII was selected based on its strong track record of producing WHO-prequalified vaccines, affordably and at scale, and meeting stringent global quality and regulatory standards,” the communication said.

The World Health Organization estimates a vaccine with this efficacy profile could prevent 76 million new TB cases, save 8.5 million lives, and save \$41.5 billion for TB-affected households over 25 years, it added.

Zoho unveils AI-powered Classes 2.0 learning platform

Rohan Das
Chennai

SaaS major Zoho on Wednesday announced the launch of Zoho Classes 2.0, the latest iteration of the company’s made-in-India learning management system (LMS) that is set to take on global incumbents such as Google Classroom and Moodle. Launched initially during the Covid-19 pandemic as an assignment tool, Zoho Classes has since been built into an AI-powered academic platform for both government and private educational institutions.

Speaking to *businessline*, Dev Anand Ramasamy, Vice-President of Product Management, Zoho said that company’s focus with Zoho Classes 2.0 is centred on ‘regulated’ institutions that are under the purview of government agencies such as UGC, AICTE, NMC and various State boards.

Ramasamy believes that the challenges in the education system today come from a combination of digitally native students who do not connect with traditional teaching methods, teachers who are overburdened with administrative work and the increasing compliance requirements for schools and colleges.

The company is also making Zoho Classes 2.0 available at no product licensing cost to all Central and State Government schools, colleges and universities, in a move to democratise access



Dev Anand Ramasamy, Vice-President of Product Management at Zoho

to educational technology. Additionally, any teacher with up to 100 students can use the platform free of charge.

AI FOCUS

“With Zoho Classes we want to bring AI in the middle of this equation. The goal is to provide a personalised digital learning experience for students while simultaneously helping teachers and institutions with repetitive administrative and regulatory tasks,” he said.

On the business side, while the platform accounts for a small share of Zoho’s revenues, Ramasamy said it has seen good growth.

The platform comes with multiple AI learning tools for students like an AI tutor, interactive quizzes and course modules. As for teachers, it can automatically generate lesson plans, create complete courses and help in evaluations.

While the latest version is currently being launched in India, it is expected to be rolled out globally in the next few months.

TTK PRESTIGE LIMITED
Regd. Office: Plot No.38, SIPCOT Industrial Complex, Hosur - 635 126, Tamil Nadu.
Corporate Office: # 1/1&1/2, 'Nagarjuna Castle', Wood Street, Richmond Town, Bangalore-560025.
E-mail: investorhelp@ttkprestige.com Website: www.ttkprestige.com
CIN: L85110T21955PLC015049

NOTICE
NOTICE is hereby given that the following share certificate(s) has/have been reported as lost / misplaced and the holder of the share certificate(s) has applied to the company for issue of duplicate share certificate(s).

Sl.No.	Folio No.	Share Certificate No.	Distinctive No.(s) From To	No. of Shares	Name of the Shareholder
1	TTK012676	239036	137543931 137545130	1200	KAMALA DEVI PARAKH

Please note that if the company does not receive any objection within 15 days from the publication of this notice, the Company will proceed further in issuing duplicate share certificates to the respective holders.

For TTK Prestige Limited
Manjula K V
Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

Date: 16th July, 2026

SOUTH INDIAN Bank
EXPERIENCE NEXT-GEN BANKING

UNAUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026
₹ in Lakhs

Particulars	Standalone			Consolidated		
	Quarter ended 30.06.2026	Quarter ended 30.06.2025	Year ended 31.03.2026	Quarter ended 30.06.2026	Quarter ended 30.06.2025	Year ended 31.03.2026
	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited	Unaudited	Unaudited	Audited
Total income from operations	3,00,730	2,98,433	11,85,599	3,00,740	2,98,413	11,85,528
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	50,746	43,294	1,95,604	50,750	43,324	1,95,611
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	50,746	43,294	1,95,604	50,750	43,324	1,95,611
Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	37,763	32,195	1,45,514	37,766	32,217	1,45,564
Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)] (Refer Note 3)			NA			
Paid up Equity Share Capital	26,181	26,163	26,176	26,181	26,163	26,176
Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserves)	11,20,848	9,79,305	10,82,842	11,20,938	9,79,364	10,82,930
Securities Premium Account	2,86,156	2,85,696	2,86,028	2,86,156	2,85,696	2,86,028
Net worth	11,37,922	9,97,249	11,00,363	11,37,612	9,97,300	11,00,449
Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt	3,60,694	1,72,809	3,92,701	3,60,694	1,72,809	3,92,701
Outstanding Redeemable Preference Shares	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Debt Equity Ratio ¹	0.10	0.09	0.12	0.10	0.09	0.12
Earnings Per Share (of ₹ 1/- each) *						
Basic :	1.44	1.23	5.56	1.44	1.23	5.56
Diluted :	1.44	1.23	5.55	1.44	1.23	5.55
Capital Redemption Reserve	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil
Debt Redemption Reserve	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil
Debt Service Coverage Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA
Interest Service Coverage Ratio	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA	NA

For Result web link

¹Debt represents borrowings with residual maturity of more than one year.

Note:

- The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly/annual financial results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 30 and 33 of the Listing Regulations. The full format of the quarterly/annual financial results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchange(s) at <https://www.bseindia.com>, <https://www.nseindia.com> and also on Banks' website: <https://www.southindianbank.bank.in>
- Detailed disclosures as specified in Regulation 33 and other applicable Regulations of SEBI (LODR) Regulations, 2015 have been made to the BSE/NSE Ltd and can be accessed on <https://www.bseindia.com> and can be accessed on the following URL and Quick Response Code:
BSE Ltd: <https://www.bseindia.com/xml-data/corplisting/AttachLive/4919294b-076d-425b-9b84-37eb75704dcb.pdf>
NSE Ltd: https://searchives.nseindia.com/corporate/SOUTHBANK_16072026133912_SD_STF_FINANCIALRESULTS_16JULY2026.pdf
- Information relating to total comprehensive income and other comprehensive income is not furnished as Ind AS is not yet made applicable to Banks.

Date : July 16, 2026 Place: Kochi

The South Indian Bank Ltd. Regd. Office, SIB House, P.B. No.28, Thrissur, Kerala, PIN-680 001, Ph: 0487 2420020, Toll Free (India): 1800-102-9408, 1800-425-1809 (BSNL), Email: sibcorporate@sib.bank.in, www.southindianbank.bank.in, CIN: L65191K19299C001017

P R Seshadri
(Managing Director & CEO) (DIN : 07820690)

Onida eyes 5x growth in five years, charts plan

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai



Gunjan Srivastava, CEO & MD, Onida Electronics Ltd, at a press conference in Chennai **BIJAY GHOSH**

Onida, a consumer electronics brand that ruled Indian households during the 1980s and 1990s, is embarking on a transformation strategy and has set a target of “growing five-fold over the next five years”.

This will involve the company strengthening core product categories, exploring new product development, honing sales channels and after-sales services and improving brand positioning to reconnect with consumers, Gunjan Srivastava, MD and CEO, Onida Electronics, told *businessline* in an interaction.

The 45-year-old company, which admits it lost ground to global electronics majors in the last decade, is also moving away from contract manufacturing business to focus entirely on branded product business. This will be achieved via expanding physical presence through exclusive brand outlets, said Srivastava.

“We are looking at having at least 100 exclusive Onida brand stores across the country in the next three years or so,” he said. “Overall, the product categories may grow 7-10 per cent annually, but we intend to outperform the market by several times,” the executive added.

EXPAND PORTFOLIO

Onida’s current product portfolio includes air conditioners, televisions and washing machines. It is evaluating entry into new segments over the next 3-5 years, including refrigerators and smart home solutions.

While Onida has both contract and in-house manufacturing, the CEO said that manufacturing could be brought internal for selective products as volumes scale up. The company has also launched a 100-inch QD Mini LED television, marking its entry into the ultra-large screen segment. The product is positioned around premium picture quality and superior audio performance, the CEO said.

Onida clocked a net loss of ₹74 crore and revenue of around ₹670 crore in FY26.

Its plans for revival began earlier this month with sweeping management rejig. Srivastava, who has been CEO since February, was recently also appointed as MD. A new CFO and chief people officer has also been brought in. The promoter, Kaval Mirchandani, continues to be on the Board.

Interestingly, the company is also in the process of surveying various consumer groups to see how it can redefine the brand for younger buyers while retaining its legacy appeal. “Our main [marketing] focus is going to be the newer channels, essentially digital media and social influencers,” he added.

CIAL COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LTD

CIAL/COMM/SHW/74 **TENDER NOTICE** 17-07-2026

Online Item Rate E-tenders are invited from reputed agencies for the work mentioned below at Cochin International Airport Ltd.

Sl.No.	Name of Work	Estimate	EMD	Period
1	SITC of Printers & Software Licenses	Rs.2.75 Crore + GST	Rs.5.50 Lakh	04 Weeks

Interested firms may register themselves on the online E-Tendering portal <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> and then download the Tender documents. For eligibility criteria and other details, visit our website www.cial.aero

Sd/-
MANAGING DIRECTOR

ONGC
Oil and Natural Gas Corporation

MIRPL
Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited

Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise and A Subsidiary of ONGC Limited)
CIN - L19200KA19886G0008950
Regd. Office: Mudpadav, Kuthethoor PO.,
Via Kalipalla, Mangaluru - 575 030, Karnataka.

STATEMENT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER ENDED JUNE 30, 2026

The Board of Directors of the Company, at its Meeting held on July 15, 2026, approved the Standalone and Consolidated unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended June 30, 2026.

The results along with the Limited Review Report, have been hosted on the Company's website at <https://www.mrpl.co.in/RecentResult> and can be accessed by scanning the Quick Response (QR) Code.

By Order of the Board
For Mangalore Refinery and Petrochemicals Limited
Sd./-
Devendra Kumar
Director Finance (DIN: 11000531)

Place : Mangaluru
Date : 15/07/2026

Note: The above disclosure is in accordance with Regulation 33 read with Regulation 47(1) of the SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

QUICKLY.

Gold falls as US rate hike bets resurface



Gold fell two per cent on Thursday, as escalating West Asian tensions reinforced expectations of elevated US interest rates. Spot gold was down 1.5 per cent at \$4,001.17 per ounce by 1326 GMT. US gold futures dropped 1.1 per cent to \$4,005.20. Silver dropped 2.8 per cent to \$56.17. REUTERS

Crude oil slips as traders resort to profit booking

Tokyo/Beijing: Crude oil prices trended lower as traders took profits and evaluated the risks from a new wave of US strikes on Iranian military installations, which fuelled fears of supply disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz. Brent crude futures slipped 24 cents to \$84.95 a barrel as of 0435 GMT, while US WTI futures fell 15 cents to \$79.45 a barrel. REUTERS

Nickel at 3-week high on sulphur supply issues



London: Nickel rose to a more than three-week high as concerns over disruption to traffic through the Strait of Hormuz renewed fears of shortages of key raw material sulphur. Benchmark three month nickel on the LME was up 1.8 per cent at \$17,110 a tonne as of 0900 GMT. Copper nudged up 0.1 per cent to \$13,599. REUTERS

Tapping inland fishery, govt to unveil export-focused policy soon

LEVERAGING TECH.

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Union government is preparing an export-oriented policy for fisheries with a special emphasis on inland fishery, which has a share of only 2 per cent in India's overall export in the sector, said Animal Husbandry and Fisheries Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh.

He asked the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR) to take its technologies to the doorstep of every fisherman so that real economic benefits reach the fish farmers.

The Minister said transport is a major bottleneck for making inland fisheries connected with export hubs and asked the ICAR to study if using drones for transporting the products and inputs for farming could be a solution.

Officials cited an instance of shrimp farming in Haryana's Sirsa and other districts where seeds are procured from Andhra Pradesh, West Bengal and Tamil Nadu; then, they are picked up from the Delhi airport and transported directly to the fish ponds.

The Minister said fishery exports in 2025-26 jumped by about ₹10,000 crore to more than ₹72,000 crore. He credited India's free trade agreements (FTAs) with several countries for achieving the success.

NEXT 2 YEARS TARGET

Addressing the foundation day event of the ICAR, Singh credited its scientists with providing necessary technologies to make India the largest producer of milk and the second biggest in fisheries in the world.

He assured them that his Ministry would release more funds to the ICAR to carry on research, provided the technologies reach the farmers.

Speaking on the occasion,



TRADE TAILWINDS. Fishery exports in 2025-26 surged by nearly ₹10,000 crore to exceed ₹72,000 crore, driven in part by India's free trade agreements with several countries

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan set some targets for the ICAR scientists to achieve in the next two years when it celebrates its 100th Foundation Day in 2028.

Chouhan asked for the development of at least 100 climate-smart villages by the centenary as well as the deployment of 100 young scientists to work on frontier

areas, such as artificial intelligence, robotics, gene editing and climate-smart agriculture. He asked each of ICAR's 113 institutes and affiliated agricultural universities to develop one innovation with demonstrable national impact.

He added that each ICAR institution should adopt one aspirational district and build a replicable model of

agricultural transformation there.

LOW PULSES YIELD

He urged the ICAR to intensify its efforts to raise productivity in pulses and oilseeds without genetically modified technology, where India continues to rely heavily on imports. "If countries without access to GM seeds can get better yields in pulses, why can't India?" he asked.

Pointing out that once they get access to irrigation, farmers tend to shift towards rice and wheat, he said it was a trend witnessed across Madhya Pradesh, Bihar, Odisha and other parts of eastern India, pushing the country to depend on pulses imports to meet demand.

Terming the low productivity of 5 quintals per acre in tur, urad and moong as a major challenge, he asked ICAR's Director General ML Jat to find a solution.

US anti-dumping, countervailing duties hit paprika exports

V Sajeed Kumar
Kochi

The US Department of Commerce's decision to impose anti-dumping and countervailing duties on oleoresin paprika (red chilli extract) imports from India has left the spice export industry facing significant uncertainty.

According to industry sources, the action follows a petition filed by a US manufacturer with the US International Trade Commission (USITC), alleging that Indian exporters were selling oleoresin paprika at unfairly



low prices, causing material injury to domestic producers.

The countervailing duty ranges from 18.56 per cent to 25.41 per cent and has been made applicable from February 2026, while anti-dumping duties ranging from 3.33 per cent to 4.66 per cent have been imposed retrospectively from June.

Oleoresin paprika, a natural extract derived from red chillies, is widely used by US buyers in food colouring, cosmetics and spice formulations

Emmanuel Nambusseril, President of the All India

Spices Exporters Forum, said the duties come on top of the additional tariffs that the US is considering on Indian imports under Section 301 provisions related to forced labour concerns, estimated at 10-12.5 per cent.

LARGEST MARKET

"The US is one of the largest markets for oleoresin manufacturers in India. The cumulative impact of these measures will severely affect exporters," he said.

Oleoresin paprika, a natural extract derived from red chillies, is widely used by US buyers in food colouring,

cosmetics and spice formulations.

India remains a leading supplier of oleoresin paprika to the US market. Trade data show that annual exports have ranged between \$54.6 million and \$68 million, with shipment volumes of 2.1-2.5 million kg.

Industry stakeholders fear that the combined impact of anti-dumping duties, countervailing duties and any additional tariffs could erode India's competitiveness in the US market, forcing exporters to either absorb higher costs or look for alternative destinations.

Oilmeal exports dip 21.5% in April on shipping woes, S. American pricing

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Oilmeal exports declined to 3.65 lakh tonnes (lt) in April 2026 from 4.65 lt a year ago, registering a fall of 21.5 per cent.

BV Mehta, Executive Director of the Solvent Extractors' Association of India (SEA), attributed this decline to Red Sea shipping disruptions, higher freight costs and intense price competition from South American soybean meal.

He said Indian soybean meal exports remained uncompetitive with FOB prices at \$605 a tonne compared to the international price of around \$430 a tonne (CIF Rotterdam).

India exported 62,844 tonnes of soybean meal in April 2026 against 2.30 lt in April 2025.

RAPEMEAL EXPORTS UP

Exports of rapeseed meal increased to 2.48 lt in April 2026 from 2.13 lt in April 2025. This increase was supported by strong demand from China. Major buyers during included China, Bangladesh, Vietnam, Thailand and emerging African markets during April.

He said exports to Europe and West Asia were affected by longer transit times caused by vessel diversions around the Cape of Good Hope.

Stating that the demand for oilmeals is expected to remain mixed in the near term, he said while domestic demand from the poultry, dairy and livestock sectors is likely to remain steady, export demand may continue to face pressure due to ample supplies of soybean meal from South America and competitive pricing in the global market.

Rapeseed meal exports are expected to find support from continued buying interest from China and other

Asian markets, subject to price competitiveness.

"In the near term, oilmeal prices are likely to remain range-bound with a weak bias, influenced by the progress of the domestic monsoon, availability of the new oilseed crop, global soybean fundamentals and freight costs. Any improvement in shipping conditions in the Red Sea region or a narrowing of the price gap between Indian and international quotations could support export demand in the coming months," Mehta said.

MAJOR IMPORTERS

China imported 1.42 lt of oilmeals from India in April 2026 compared to 59,921 tonnes in April 2025.

India exported 69,272 tonnes of oilmeals to Bangladesh in April 2026 (50,191 tonnes in April 2025). Vietnam imported 49,350 tonnes of oilmeals (21,091 tonnes) during the period.

Adopt a wait-and-watch approach for zinc futures

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

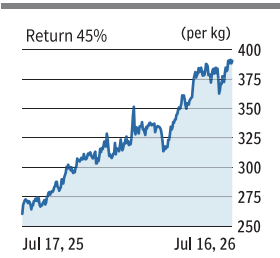
Zinc prices have risen sharply over the last three weeks. The zinc futures contract traded on the Multi Commodity Exchange has surged about 8 per cent from the low of ₹348.65 per kg last month. It is currently trading at ₹376.

COMMODITY CALL.

The recent rise has taken the zinc futures contract well above an intermediate resistance level of ₹367.

However, an important trendline resistance is ahead at ₹383. The slowdown in the pace of rise over the past week indicates that buying interest is fading out slowly. So, the price action in the coming days will need a very close watch.

A decisive break above ₹383 is needed to boost the

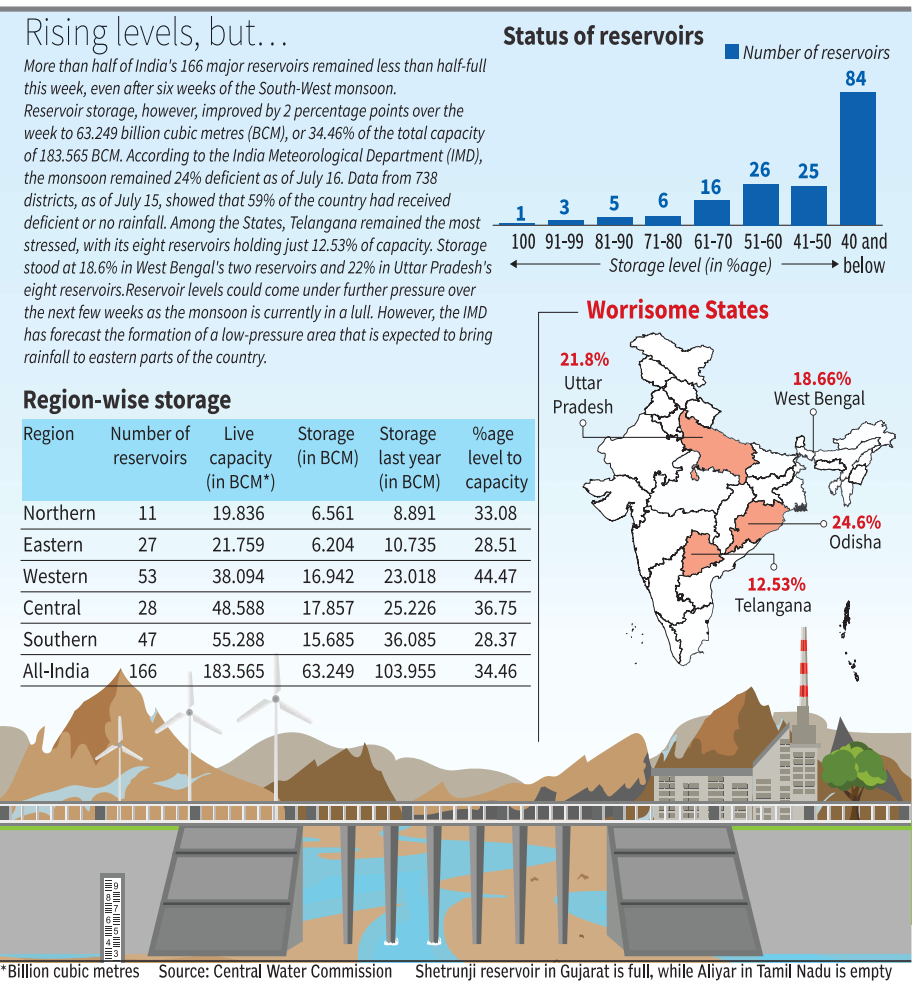


momentum and keep the current upmove intact. If that happens, there are good chances to see a rally to ₹420 in the coming weeks.

But if the contract fails to breach ₹383 and turns down, a fall to ₹365 is possible. We will have to wait and watch.

TRADE STRATEGY

Since a strong resistance is coming up, fresh long positions are not advisable at the moment. Also, to take a short position, we need to wait and see if the resistance is holding well or not. So, it is better to stay out of the market for now.



KisanKraft launches two electric farm equipment

Our Bureau
Mangaluru



KisanKraft Ltd has launched two electric-powered farm equipment — the E-Inter-cultivator and the E-Self Propelled Reaper.

A media statement said the machines will bring energy costs down from approximately ₹170 per hour for comparable petrol-powered equipment to approximately ₹10 per hour, as per its field trials.

The machines have been tested at different geographical locations and agro-climatic conditions in India with over 100 hours of testing to ensure consistent performance, reliability and durability, it said.

E-Inter-cultivator is built

for weeding and intercultural operations. Fitted with 32 J-shaped blades and weighing approximately 150 kg, it covers around one acre per hour and delivers approximately 3.5 hours of continuous operation on a single charge.

E-Self Propelled Reaper harvests around one acre per hour across paddy, wheat, millets and soybean, and delivers approximately four hours of continuous operation on a single charge.

Crystal Crop launches six innovations for kharif

Our Bureau
Mangaluru

Crystal Crop Protection Ltd has launched six innovations for the kharif 2026 season.

A media statement said the innovations strengthen Crystal Crop Protection's leadership across key crop segments by offering integrated solutions for disease, weed, insect and nutrition management, helping farmers improve productivity, reduce cultivation costs and enhance profitability.

The statement said Crystal had introduced 'Samorian' for soybean, featuring a patented three-way mode of action against grasses and broadleaf weeds.

Addressing complex weed challenges in maize, Crystal has launched its patented combination herbi-

cide 'Takuro', which offers three-layer weed management with rapid systemic action and long-lasting residual control.

In its paddy fungicide portfolio, Crystal has introduced 'Xeberia'.

This provides multi-site protection against fungal and bacterial diseases, along with the dual-action fungicide 'MAXentra', which delivers broad-spectrum disease control across multiple crop stages.

COMPREHENSIVE STRATEGY

Together, they offer a comprehensive disease management strategy for healthier crops, improved grain quality and stronger yield potential.

Crystal has introduced 'Valtruva', an advanced cotton insecticide powered by smart triple action techno-

logy. The statement said 'Valtruva' delivers rapid knock-down, broad-spectrum control of major sucking pests and extended residual protection.

By reducing spray frequency while ensuring season-long crop protection, the innovation helps cotton growers improve operational efficiency, protect yields and maximise farm productivity.

ORGANIC NUTRITION

Crystal has also launched GreenAg patented organic smart nutrition solution 'KGR-T', powered by an effervescent tablet delivery system and extended nutrient release technologies. It improves nutrient-use efficiency, enhances flowering and fruiting, strengthens crop resilience and supports better-quality yields.

Quoting Ankur Aggarwal, Chairman and Managing Director of Crystal Crop Protection, the statement said, "Indian agriculture is evolving rapidly. Climate uncertainty, changing pest dynamics and rising expectations from every acre demand a new generation of agricultural innovation. These six technologies reflect our commitment to helping farmers improve productivity, profitability and long-term sustainability."

FIELD TESTS

Sohit Satyawali, Chief Business Officer, Brands Business, Crystal Crop Protection, said every innovation in the portfolio had been developed after extensive field validation across diverse agro-climatic regions to address the evolving needs of Indian farmers.

Wheat production this crop year will likely be affected by climate

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai



India's wheat production could be impacted by the climate this crop year (July 2026-June 2027), with El Nino beginning to impact weather in the country, experts said at a wheat conclave last week.

Delayed harvest of kharif crops is on the cards. This could delay sowing of wheat, and the climate may come into play, said experts at a session on 'Global wheat markets, policy, weather and price risk' at the Wheat Products Promotion Society (WPPS) CEO Conclave in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh.

Jatin Singh, Founder and Managing Director of Sky-met, said the situation was bad for the South-West monsoon and by September, enough damage would have been done.

DROUGHT YEAR

This year may be one of drought, though the India Meteorological Department (IMD) has stopped declaring drought since 2016.

However, the silver lining could be the positive Indian Ocean Dipole, which could bring good rain during September-October. However, he did not rule out damage to the crops since the monsoon could be affected by the time the IOD emerges.

Somnath Chatterjee, Executive Vice-President and Head - procurement and logistics, ITC Food Division, said the wheat market is facing a volatile scenario due to the geopolitical crisis in West Asia and fears over El Nino.

Gaurav Jain, Co-founder and Director of Agpulse Analytics, said nations were increasing food production during war, though produc-

tion is down in some countries in the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region.

The current El Nino weather is a worry and could impact winter crop production this year. "Rabi crops may be at risk," he said.

Nations, including India and China, that witnessed good demand for wheat had increased production to 170 million tonnes (mt) from the 150 million tonnes earlier, said Jain.

Though the world is going through a tough time due to the Iran war and El Nino, the global wheat market is well supplied across the globe.

Rory Deverell, Owner and Principal Consultant at Black Silo Commodity Consulting, Ireland, said the futures market is not showing any rise in prices for the July-September period.

"There is plenty of wheat in the Black Sea region, which is anchoring supplies. There is no chance of any significant rise in wheat prices," he said.

EXPORT AS FEED

In another session, 'Procurement, Trade, Storage, Supply Chain and Food Security' at the conclave, which was organised by the WPPS in association with the UP Roller Flour Millers Association, Major Rajiv Yadav, Director and CEO of Rajshubh Agri LLP, sought hedging options in wheat to facilitate price discovery.

QUICKLY.

Dept of Space tightens
exit rules for ISRO staff

New Delhi: The Department of Space has issued a memorandum to major ISRO centres for tightening the rules governing the resignation and voluntary retirement of scientists and engineers working in critical missions of national importance such as the Gaganyaan Mission. The memorandum, issued on Tuesday, directed these centres not to routinely accept resignations or voluntary retirement requests from Group 'A' scientific and technical personnel. **PTI**

India Post eases norms on
refund of postage fee

New Delhi: India Post has allowed a refund of the postage fee upon cancellation of bookings done online or through the counter, an official notification said on Thursday. Senders who have self-booked postal articles via the web portal or mobile application can cancel the booking and claim a postage refund before the article is accepted by the post office, according to the notification. **PTI**

Goenka family to build
₹100 crore varsity

Mumbai: Essel Group Chairman Subhash Chandra and his brothers Laxmi Narain Goel, Jawahar Goel and Ashok Goel plan to set up an educational institution in Agroha, Hisar, in memory of their father Nand Kishore Goenka. They will invest nearly ₹100 crore to set up the varsity and centre of excellence on about 32 acres land available with the family. "The university will introduce a specialised and unique curriculum focused on 'Social Service' and 'Giving Back to Society,'" said the company in a press release. **OUR BUREAU**

Guidance TN continues
consultations ahead of
new industrial policy

Our Bureau
Chennai

Guidance Tamil Nadu, the investment promotion bureau, on Thursday organised the Tamil Nadu Industrial Policy Stakeholders Connect to gauge industry views as it prepares a new industrial policy.

FEEDBACK RECEIVED

Guidance TN said in a social media post that the consultation saw active participation from leading industry associations, including Tamil Nadu Fireworks and Amores Manufacturers Association (TANFAMA), the Chemical Industries Association, the Manali Industries Association, the Association of Tamil Nadu Medical Device Industry - ATMED, and the Indian Drug Manufacturers' Association

Govt has provided social security net
to over 100 crore citizens: Mandaviya

LANDMARK MOVE. ILO says the milestone holds lessons that can be shared through South-South co-operation

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

India's social protection coverage has expanded to over 100 crore citizens in 2026, up from 25 crore in 2015, said Union Labour and Employment Minister Mansukh Mandaviya.

The steep rise in social protection coverage in a decade is largely due to the government bringing into the fold informal and unorganised sector workers, who comprise nearly 90 per cent of the total 50 crore workforce. Previously, the government's focus was mainly on formal workers.

Mandaviya, in a post on X on Wednesday, flagged the landmark validation of the country's social security coverage by the International Labour Organization (ILO).

"India breaches 1 billion mark in Social Protection Coverage!" Mandaviya wrote

on X, thanking ILO Director-General Gilbert F Hounbo "for acknowledging India's efforts towards expanding social protection coverage".

In a video message at the BRICS Labour & Employment Minister's Meeting in Hyderabad on Wednesday, Hounbo said, "According to ILO running estimates, India's social protection system now reaches 1 billion people. This milestone offers lessons that can be shared through South-South cooperation."

SOCIAL PROTECTION

Mandaviya, in another post on the social media platform, attributed to the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi for the steep rise in social protection coverage, from 19 per cent in 2015 to 68.4 per cent in 2026. This brought more than 100 crore citizens under the umbrella of the social protection framework, he wrote. As per



POLICY TALKS. Union Minister Mansukh Mandaviya chairing the 12th BRICS Labour and Employment Ministers' Meeting **ANI**

data shared by the Minister in the tweet, social protection coverage doubled in between 2019 and 2022 compared with the percentage increase in the years from 2015 to 2026.

POLICY RESPONSE

This was a culmination of government's rapid policy response to the COVID-19 pandemic like the Pradhan Mantri Garib Kalyan Anna

Yojana and PM-JAY (Ayushman Bharat) Healthcare scale-up, followed by a thrust toward digitising the informal workforce, with the launch of the e-Shram portal.

On the contrary, the two-year period between 2025 and 2026 witnessed social security coverage hike of just 6.38 per cent, which is considered as stabilisation of the initiative after the exponential growth.

TVK govt's 1st Budget to focus on efficient use of funds

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

The first Budget of the Tamilaga Vetttri Kazhagam (TVK) government in Tamil Nadu will focus on the prudent utilisation of public funds. The government is assessing the State's financial position across departments before finalising its spending priorities, according to Minister for Energy Resources and Law CTR Nirmal Kumar.

"This is the first Budget of the new government. You



Tamil Nadu Minister for Energy Resources and Law CTR Nirmal Kumar **T E RAJA SIMHAN**

know what the financial status is. All the departments are bleeding financially. We need to ensure that budgets

and revenues are utilised properly for the people," he told *businessline* after the Cabinet meeting, the second since the TVK government assumed office two months ago.

Kumar said Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay had, over the past few days, held detailed discussions with all departments and urged Ministers to ensure that funds were spent efficiently and the Budget remained focused on the welfare of the people.

He said the Cabinet meeting reviewed the State's financial position. "We cannot

disclose what was discussed," he added.

PARANDUR AIRPORT

When asked for an update on the proposed Parandur greenfield airport project, the Minister said, "It has already been told. We will confirm soon," without elaborating further.

Responding to a question by newsmen on whether the proposed ₹2,100 crore Tiruvanniyur-Uthandi elevated road project had been cancelled, the Minister said the project is under review, along with other major

Spain's Inalsa invests ₹50 crore in Sonipat
appliances plant to resume local manufacturing

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Inalsa Home Appliances, the Indian arm of Spain's Taurus Group, expects its premium kitchen appliances range, led by air fryers, stand mixers and app-connected cooking systems, alongside local manufacturing and a wider distribution network, to drive its next phase of growth.

The company is returning to manufacturing after more than two decades with a ₹50 crore investment in a Sonipat plant as it looks to more than double revenue to ₹500 crore by FY29.

TWO PHASES

The five-storey manufacturing facility in Haryana, will initially produce around one lakh appliances a month before expanding capacity to four lakh units.

The investment will be ex-

ecuted in two phases, beginning with assembly operations before adding motor manufacturing and injection moulding in-house over the next two to three years.

"We produce the products on which we want exclusivity or control over the technical know-how. Other products we get from contract manufacturing," Jitendra Chauhan, Chief Executive Officer of Inalsa Home Appliances, told *businessline*.

Air fryers are Inalsa's largest category, contributing about 30 per cent of revenue, and along with vacuum cleaners, stand mixers, hand blenders and food processors, 70-75 per cent of the business.

To strengthen its premium portfolio, the company recently launched Steel Chef, an air fryer with a fully stainless-steel food-grade cooking chamber, and Blendora, a multifunction appliance that combines a



Jitendra Chauhan, Chief Executive Officer of Inalsa Home Appliances

soup maker, baby-food maker and blender.

INDIA LAUNCH

The company is also evaluating an India launch within the next six months of MyCook, its app-connected cooking robot already sold in

Raw material costs take a
toll on CEAT's net in Q1;
plans ₹1,205 cr expansion

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai



Arbab Banerjee, MD and CEO, CEAT

CEAT's Q1 FY27 performance presents a sharp growth-profitability divergence as revenue expanded by more than a fifth, but operating margins contracted and consolidated profit almost wiped out as raw-material inflation and higher finance costs offset demand gains.

Consolidated revenue from operations rose 22.4 per cent to ₹4,318 crore during the quarter from ₹3,529 crore in the comparable quarter previously. Net profit, however, plunged 96.4 per cent to ₹4 crore from ₹112 crore.

"Q1 was a challenging quarter for the industry. The continuing West Asia crisis led to significant raw-material cost inflation, which weighed on our gross and operating margins," Managing Director and CEO Arnab Banerjee said.

The EBITDA margin contracted 238 basis points to 8.56 per cent from 10.94 per cent. This implies EBITDA of about ₹370 crore, down around 4 per cent from ₹386 crore, despite the strong revenue growth.

Raw-material consumption increased 33 per cent to ₹2,978 crore (₹2,239 crore), substantially faster than revenue. "We responded with calibrated price increases to partly offset the impact, while staying focused on demand and market share," Banerjee said. Healthy demand across segments and high capacity utilisation supported the double-digit revenue growth, he added.

Finance costs climbed 78 per cent to ₹146 crore during the quarter from ₹82 crore previously. This included a ₹48-crore foreign-exchange

loss at CEAT OHT Lanka following the restatement of an \$80-million borrowing from the parent company.

Consequently, consolidated profit before exceptional items and tax fell 75.5 per cent to ₹39 crore (₹159 crore).

CLEARER VIEW

CEAT's standalone numbers offer a clearer view of its core operations. Standalone revenue rose 18.2 per cent to ₹4,163 crore in Q1 FY27 from ₹3,521 crore in Q1 FY26, while net profit declined 27.4 per cent to ₹98 crore (₹135 crore). The standalone EBITDA margin narrowed to 9.13 per cent from 11.11 per cent. CFO Kumar Subbiah cautioned that raw-material costs were likely to remain elevated in Q2 FY27. "We will continue to balance our pricing actions and cost prudence to progressively mitigate the impact on our margins," he said.

Despite the near-term pressure, CEAT approved an investment of about ₹1,205 crore to add 53,000 two-wheeler tyres a day progressively by FY31. This amounts to a 66 per cent addition over its existing owned capacity of about 80,000 tyres a day, which is operating at nearly 95 per cent utilisation. The expansion will be financed through internal accruals and debt.

Kandla surpasses 50 mt
cargo handling 19 days ahead
in the current fiscal

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad

The Deendayal Port Authority (DPA) at Kandla in Gujarat has crossed the 50 million tonne cargo handling milestone for the current financial year 19 days ahead of last year.

The milestone comes on the back of strong first-quarter performance, with Kandla retaining its position as India's largest major port during April-June FY27, according to provisional data released by the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways.

It handled 42.76 mt of cargo during the period, accounting for 18.3 per cent of the total cargo handled by the country's 12 major ports. Kandla was followed by Paradip Port Authority, which handled 39.67 mt and Jawaharlal Nehru Port Au-

thority, which handled 27.84 mt.

The latest performance reinforces Kandla's position as the leading major port by cargo volumes, supported by strong movement across both overseas and coastal segments.

OVERSEAS CARGO

During April-June FY27, Deendayal Port remained the largest handler of overseas cargo among major ports, accounting for 21.17 per cent of the total overseas cargo handled during the period.

The port recorded 12.75 per cent growth in overseas cargo and 12.96 per cent growth in coastal cargo compared with the corresponding period last year.

Overall, cargo handled at India's major ports increased 6.18 per cent year-on-year during April-June FY27 to 233.64 mt (220.04 mt).

AP Minister Nara Lokesh apologises to
Amara Raja group, says come back home

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Andhra Pradesh Minister for IT & Human Resources, Nara Lokesh, while congratulating Amara Raja group on its ₹500-cr investment in neighbouring Telangana, apologised to Jayadev Galla, Co-founder and Chairman, for the problems it had faced in Andhra Pradesh under the previous regime and hoped the group would invest in its home State.

The company had shifted its headquarters and investments to Telangana from Andhra Pradesh when the YSR Congress Party was in power in 2019-24.

Lokesh said, for over four decades, Amara Raja with its home town in Chittoor, has been more than just one of Andhra Pradesh's greatest

The company
had shifted its
headquarters and
investments to
Telangana from
AP when the
YSR Congress
Party was in power

industrial success stories. It has created world-class manufacturing, generated thousands of jobs, and carried the name of Chittoor and Andhra Pradesh across India and the world, Lokesh said.

The Minister, referring to the issues it had faced previously in the State, which made the company shift new investments to Telangana, said: "The harassment your company endured under the previous government should never have happened. An en-

trepreneur who chose to build in his home State deserved encouragement, not intimidation. It pains me that a company born in Andhra Pradesh had to look beyond our borders for its next chapter of growth."

“REBUILD TRUST”

Inviting Amara Raja back to Andhra Pradesh, he said: "As we rebuild trust, Andhra Pradesh is once again open for enterprise. We hope Amara Raja's biggest chapters will still be written in the State where its journey began. Our doors, and our hearts, will always remain open. Best wishes on your new Telangana facility," he said.

On Wednesday Amara Raja Advanced Cell Technologies commissioned a new plant in Mahbubnagar, Telangana with an investment of ₹500 crore.

Telangana, Microsoft pact
to set up Green Skills CoE

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

The Telangana government, in association with Microsoft, will establish a Green Skills & Applied AI Centre of Excellence (CoE) to equip youth with AI-ready skills for sustainable manufacturing. It will help create a talent pipeline for the rapidly evolving green economy and AI-driven industrial ecosystem.

With a focus on green pharma, the CoE is being set up in association with Microsoft, 1M1B Foundation (One Million for One Billion), and the Union Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology's Startup Hub.

The centre will begin its operations from next month, a government spokesperson

said. "Artificial intelligence is rapidly becoming the operating system for sustainable industries. In life sciences and pharmaceutical manufacturing, AI has the potential to improve productivity, optimise energy use, accelerate research, and enable more sustainable operations," Rajiv Kumar, Managing Director and President, Microsoft India Development Centre, said in a statement on Thursday.

"By combining applied AI with green skills, we are preparing a new generation of innovators who can create solutions for both economic growth and climate resilience," he said.

TN to start phase 1 of Census 2027 on
Aug 1; online self enumeration starts today

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Directorate of Census Operations, Tamil Nadu, announced that it will conduct the first phase of the 16th National Census over the course of a month starting from August 1.

Speaking at a press conference here on Thursday, Sundaresh Babu, Chief Principal Census Officer, Tamil Nadu, said that the first phase will involve the Houselisting and Housing Census. Citizens can opt for self enumeration using the government portal from July 17 to July 31.

FOUNDATIONAL STAGE

"This is a foundational stage where we collect essential information regarding household details. It will include 33 questions on

household amenities, drinking water, sanitation, electricity, internet connectivity, cooking fuel and other factors. The phase will serve as a framework for the deeper population census in the second phase, scheduled for February of 2027," he said.

DATA COLLECTION

Babu added that for the first time, the entire enumeration process will be 100 per cent digital with all data collection to be done digitally.

"We have assigned 200-250 households for each enumerator. They have been selected from different government departments and have been given three full days of training for this process. Every six enumerators will have one supervisor," he said.

Tamil Nadu has about

1,026 operational units, 'charges', to organise and conduct the population count. Each will be led by a Charge Officer or Sub-Division Officer.

Babu added that about 20 States have already completed phase one of the Census and are preparing for phase 2.

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thehindu businessline.

QUICKLY.

Uber offers \$14.8 b to buy Germany's Delivery Hero



Berlin: Uber on Thursday launched a public takeover offer for Delivery Hero that values the German food delivery company at \$14.8 billion and would create the world's largest food-delivery firm outside China. The transaction would create a platform spanning 99 countries with combined pro-forma gross merchandise value of \$236 billion in 2025. REUTERS

Lilly's AtaiBeckley deal marks psychedelics' entry

Eli Lilly will buy AtaiBeckley for up to \$3.8 billion, the company said on Thursday, joining a race among pharma majors to develop psychedelic treatments for mental health conditions. The deal taps into rising interest in psychedelics following easing regulations in the US and to diversify its product portfolio. REUTERS

EU forces Google to share search data with rivals



Brussels: The European Union issued two new rules for Google on Thursday to force it to share search data and open up its Android operating system to rival AI companies. The EU said it will support innovation and diversity in the field by enabling fair access to AI features on Android devices and search engines. 771

Centre will explain its stance on dynamic airfare pricing to SC

KEY REQUIREMENT. Aviation Minister says the framework is a global practice and is needed for connectivity

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Centre will explain to the Supreme Court that the existing rules and regulations governing domestic airfares are based on a dynamic pricing framework, which remains essential for the growth of the aviation sector, said Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Ram Mohan Naidu.

Speaking on the sidelines of an industry event here on Thursday, the Minister said that the Centre would present its rationale behind permitting dynamic airfare pricing before the apex court.

The remarks come as the Centre is preparing its re-



UNDER WATCH. The DGCA monitors airfare trends and requires airlines to maintain transparency REUTERS

sponse before the apex court in a matter relating to regulation of airline ticket prices.

According to the Minister, dynamic pricing is an internationally-accepted practice

and is necessary for expanding aviation connectivity.

"Aviation is an industry that we are moving forward with the help of dynamic fare pricing because it is an inter-

national practice. Everywhere it happens that if we want to move forward with aviation or connectivity, then we should provide the dynamic pricing facility to the airlines, which we are extending in India as well," he said.

ACCEPTABLE LEVELS

However, Naidu said the Ministry of Civil Aviation intervenes whenever it finds that airfares are rising beyond acceptable levels or where instances of predatory pricing are noticed.

Besides, the Minister cited instances such as the Pahalgam situation, the IndiGo operational disruption and the Kumbh Mela, where the government stepped in to regulate fares.

"Whether it is in relation to IndiGo crisis, or in relation to Kumbh, whenever we feel that predatory pricing is happening, then we have put a restriction that this pricing should be regulated," Naidu said.

RETAINING PRICING

Currently, airlines continue to determine fares under the prevailing dynamic pricing framework. The Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) also monitors airfare trends and requires airlines to maintain transparency in fare display.

The minister, however, reiterated that retaining a dynamic pricing framework remains important for the aviation sector.

Foreign airlines bolster premium offerings

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

International airlines are increasing their premium offering on India routes on the back of high demand for business and first-class seats.

Lufthansa began deploying Airbus A380 aircraft on Munich-Mumbai route last week. From October 25, Emirates will operate an A380 aircraft from Delhi to Dubai.

The A380 aircraft of both these airlines have premium dense configurations which means these have more business and first-class seats than Airbus A350 or Boeing 777.

"We're seeing very strong demand across India, particularly for premium travel, and the deployment of the

A380 allows us to respond to that demand with significantly greater premium capacity.

The aircraft offers more business class and premium economy seats, while also re-introducing Lufthansa's first-class on the Mumbai route. This gives customers travelling between India and Europe even more choice, complementing the daily first-class offering already available on Swiss services to Mumbai," said Kevin Markette, Lufthansa Group Senior Director - Regional Sales South Asia.

STRONG DEMAND

Markette said the A380 will be flown to Mumbai in the summer schedule and its deployment reflects strong demand between India and Europe.



Other carriers too are tapping the opportunity with Swiss operating a second daily to Delhi till the end of October and British Airways increasing frequencies on Delhi and Bengaluru routes.

These moves come amid increased competition and changes in traffic flows following tensions in West Asia. Air India is upping its game by deploying its latest in-

flight products to Frankfurt, London and Tokyo.

Several governments had issued travel advisories asking their citizens to avoid travelling to the West Asia region.

These had an had impact on transit flows via hubs such as Dubai or Doha, benefiting the European airlines. The situation is slowly improving now.

A source said Emirates is seeing big demand for premium and business class seats on Delhi routes prompting it to deploy the A380 service from October.

The Emirates A380 has up to six extra first-class and up to 26 more business class seats than its Boeing 777s.

PREMIUM TRAVEL

The deployment of large premium aircraft such as

A380 on key India routes reflect airlines' confidence in sustained demand for premium travel from India, said Indiver Rastogi, President and Group Head - Global Business Travel, Thomas Cook (India) and SOTC Travel.

FCM Travel's Managing Director Sunny Sodhi said the firm has seen double-digit year on year growth in business and first-class transactions on India routes led by MNCs.

"Demand via Gulf hubs declined sharply following the government advisories but has gradually recovered as airlines restored capacity to around 90 per cent of the previous levels," he said.

"Yet many corporates continue to take a wait and watch approach to travel via Gulf carriers," Sodhi added.

Skyroot Aerospace ready for Vikram-1 launch tomorrow

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Skyroot Aerospace's maiden test flight of Vikram-1 is scheduled for lift-off from the first launch pad at Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh, at 11.30 am on July 18.

This will mark the arrival of Indian private-sector spacetechnology companies in the lucrative global launch business.

The Hyderabad-based spacetechnology unicorn has received all the permissions to launch the mission, christened Mission Aagam, on Saturday morning.

Vikram-1 will carry technology demonstration payloads from Grahaa Space, Cosmoserve, DCubed and Skyroot's own Scope, along with Cosmos Diamonds' artwork 'Cosmic Bloom' and a micro-art piece.



Skyroot Aerospace's maiden test flight Vikram-1 launch vehicle fully stacked at SDSC-SHAR

FIRST PRIVATE ROCKET

Vikram-1 is a seven-storey-tall, multi-stage orbital launch vehicle, built with an all-carbon composite structure. It is designed to carry small satellites weighing up to 350 kg to a low-Earth orbit (LEO).

This will be the first time a private player is attempting an orbital-class rocket launch in India.

The authorities concerned have issued the necessary airspace and maritime notices, formally designating restricted zones along Vikram-1's ascent and impact corridor for the launch day.

"We have done everything that could be done to test Vikram-1 on the ground. On July 18, we are eager to see how Vikram-1 performs in a real flight environment for the first time," Pawan Kumar Chandana, Co-founder and Chief Executive Officer of Skyroot Aerospace, said.

"This is our first test flight, and we will be getting valuable data from it," he said.

"This will be foundational to Skyroot's aspirations to establish a launch cadence. We are excited to see this through," he added.

CONSTRAINED SUPPLY

"The small satellite launch market is deeply constrained on the supply side. At the same time, the demand for services enabled by satellites in space will only continue to grow, and that is where Skyroot's opportunity lies," Pawan said.

"With in-flight data gathered from this mission, we will return to the shop floor to learn, improve and build further," said Naga Bharath Daka, Co-founder and Chief Operating Officer, Skyroot Aerospace.

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